CTDMS

Central Transport & Dispatch Management System

Master (Administrator) User Manual

For the person who sets up, controls, checks and answers for the whole system

Prepared for Tulsyan CFA | Application version 1.5.1 | October 2026

All screens in this manual were captured from the live application using sample (demo) data.

Contents

1. Who is the Master and what is this manual for **3**

What CTDMS does, in one picture . . . 3

What makes the Master different . . . 3

Pages you will use most . . . 3

2. Signing in and finding your way **4**

Changing your own password . . . 4

3. The Dashboard **5**

The filters . . . 5

How to read the tiles . . . 5

4. Setting up the system (do this first) **7**

4.1 Master records (Companies, CFAs, Locations, Customers, Transporters, Autos) . . . 7

4.2 ERP mappings . . . 10

4.3 Integration settings (ERP connections) . . . 10

5. Freight rates **13**

5.1 Transporter rate cards . . . 13

5.2 Principal freight rates . . . 14

5.3 When a rate is missing . . . 16

6. Getting invoices into CTDMS **17**

6.1 Add Invoice . . . 17

6.2 Invoice Import . . . 17

6.3 Invoice Register . . . 19

7. Dispatch desk: from gatepass to delivery **21**

7.1 Scan & Gatepass (making a gatepass) . . . 21

7.2 The gatepass page . . . 21

7.3 Gate Check (the guard) . . . 23

7.4 LR Pending . . . 24

7.5 Track Shipment and proof of delivery . . . 24

7.6 Customer Alerts . . . 26

7.7 Pending Dispatch and Dispatch Register . . . 26

8. Approvals and overrides: the two-person rule **29**

Cancelling and voiding . . . 29

9. Transporter bills: checking what you are charged **30**

Steps . . . 30

What the checks catch . . . 31

10. Reports, MIS and exports **32**

E-mailed reports . . . 33

11. Administration: Users, Roles, Settings, Audit **35**

11.1 Users . . . 35

11.2 Roles and permissions . . . 36

11.3 System settings . . . 37

11.4 Audit log . . . 39

11.5 Data export and backup . . . 39

12. Problems that happen on the job, and what to do **40**

13. Looking after the system: Master's routine **42**

Daily . . . 42

Weekly . . . 42

Monthly . . . 42

Starting and stopping the application (office server) . . . 42

Before real use (go-live checklist) . . . 42

Paid features that are locked . . . 42

Appendix A. Permission list **43**

Appendix B. Words used in this manual **43**

1. Who is the Master and what is this manual for

The **Master** is the person with the **Administrator** role. The Administrator can open every screen, change every setting and see every company, CFA, customer and transporter. Other staff see only what their role allows; the Master decides what that is. This manual covers every part of the application from the Master's point of view: how to set it up, how to run it day to day, how to check it, and what to do when something goes wrong.

What CTDMS does, in one picture

Step	What happens	Where in the menu
1. Invoice arrives	Invoices from SAP, MARG, CBO or Intrect come in by file, drop folder, QR scan or typing.	Operations › Invoice Import / Add Invoice, Dispatch desk › Scan & Gatepass
2. Freight is priced	Each invoice gets cases × rate per case. If there is no rate it is flagged RATE MISSING.	Masters › Transporter Rate Cards / Principal Freight Rates; Operations › Freight Exceptions
3. Gatepass	One gatepass covers a whole pickup (many customers, many invoices). It is printed with a barcode.	Dispatch desk › Scan & Gatepass / Gatepasses
4. Gate-out	The guard scans the barcode, counts cases and confirms. Invoices become DISPATCHED.	Dispatch desk › Gate Check
5. LR number	The transporter's receipt (LR / bilty) number is entered, one per customer.	Dispatch desk › LR Pending
6. Delivery proof	Delivered / short / damaged / refused, with date and a photo of the signed LR.	Dispatch desk › Deliveries Pending / Track Shipment
7. Transporter bill	The bill is checked line by line against our own gatepasses, approved by a second person, then paid.	Operations › Scan a Bill / Transporter Bills
8. Reports	Dashboard, MIS, cost per case, delivery performance, audit trail. Export to Excel, CSV or PDF.	Dashboard, Reports

What makes the Master different

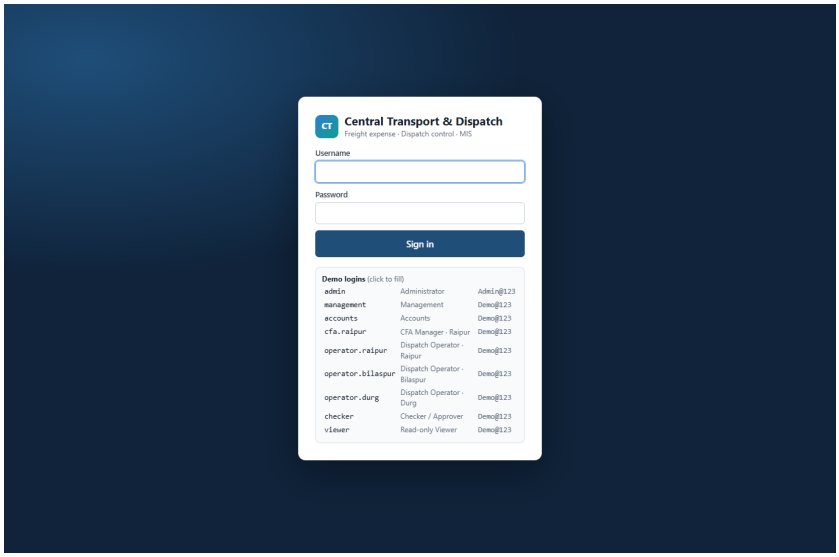
- Sees **all** companies and CFAs (other users can be limited to a few).
- Is the only role that can create users, change roles, change system settings and set up ERP connections.
- Can download a full copy of the data (ZIP of CSV files).
- Can do everything an Operator, CFA Manager, Checker, Accounts person or Management user can do. For control, the system still keeps a record of every action under the Master's name.

CAUTION Because the Master can do everything, most day-to-day work should still be done by the staff with the matching role. Use the Master login for set-up, checking and problem-solving, and keep its password private.

Pages you will use most

The left-hand menu is the same for everybody, but each person sees only the items their role allows. The Master sees all five groups: **Dispatch desk**, **Operations**, **Masters**, **Reports** and **Administration**. The box at the top left finds any invoice, LR, gatepass or e-way bill number from any page.

2. Signing in and finding your way



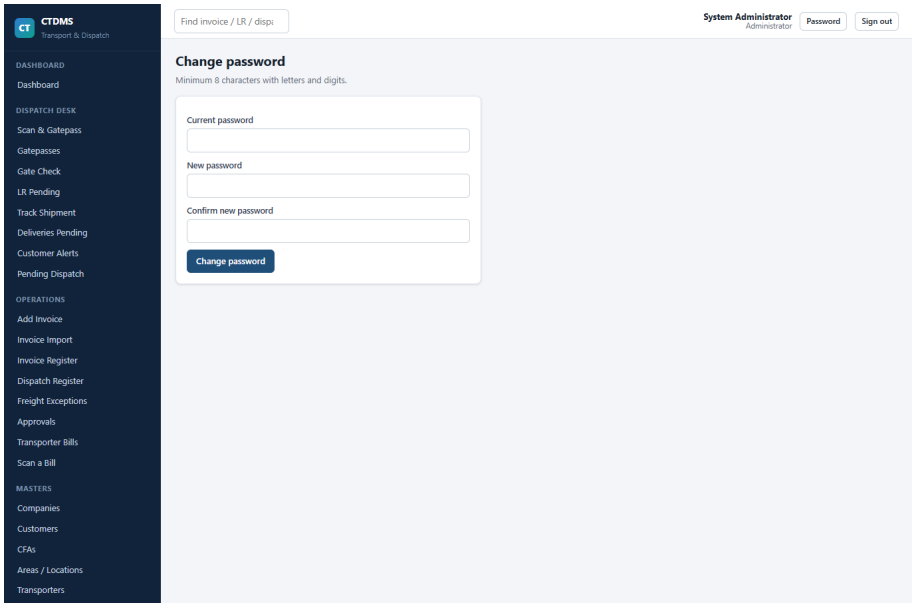
The sign-in page. In production the list of demo users is hidden.

1. Open the address your office server gives you (for example **http://server-name:8000**).
2. Type your **username** and **password** and press Sign in. There is no Google or Microsoft sign-in.
3. The first time (or after the Master sets a new password) you may be asked to choose a new password.
4. Use **Sign out** at the top right when you leave the desk. A session ends by itself after 8 hours without use.

PROBLEM Wrong password: after **5** wrong attempts the account is locked for **15 minutes**. The Master can unlock it at once from Administration › Users › the user › *Set password & unlock*.

Changing your own password

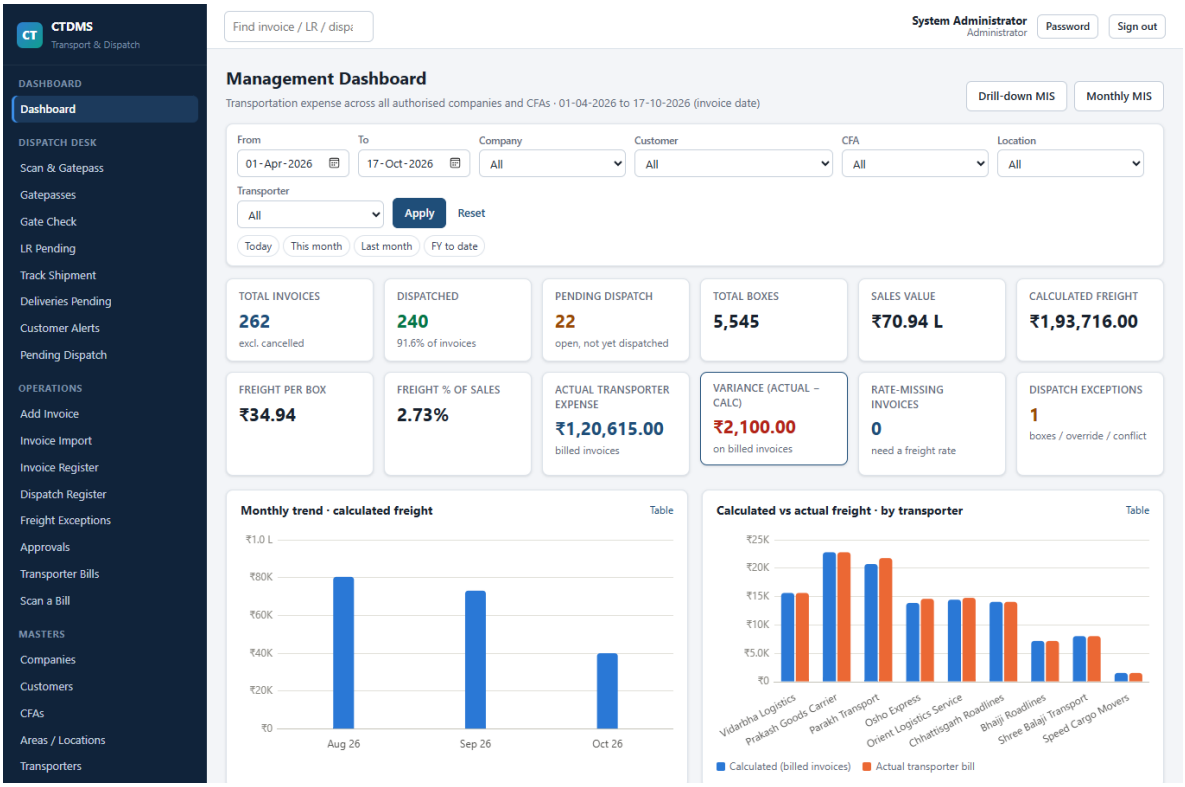
Click **Password** at the top right, enter the old and the new password, save. Do this on the first day.



Change password screen.

3. The Dashboard

The Dashboard is the Master's control panel. It shows the whole business for the selected period (default: financial year to date).



Management Dashboard: filters, key figures and charts.

The filters

Choose **From / To** dates, and optionally a Company, Customer, CFA, Location or Transporter, then press **Apply**. The buttons *Today, This month, Last month, FY to date* set the dates quickly. **Reset** clears everything.

How to read the tiles

Tile	Meaning
Total invoices / Dispatched / Pending	How many invoices exist (cancelled ones excluded), how many have left the warehouse, and how many are still waiting.
Total boxes, Sales value	Cases and rupee value of the invoices in the period.
Calculated freight	What the system calculated from the rate cards (cases × rate).
Freight per box, Freight % of sales	Cost control figures. Compare month to month.
Actual transporter expense	What transporters actually billed on billed invoices.
Variance (actual − calculated)	Red means transporters billed more than the system expected. Click it to find out why (Reports › Variance).
Rate-missing invoices	Invoices that cannot be priced because no rate exists. Should be 0. See Freight Exceptions.
Dispatch exceptions	Invoices stopped for a box-count, override or conflict problem.

Below the tiles are charts (monthly trend, calculated vs actual freight by transporter, and more). Each chart has a **Table** link that shows the same numbers as a table. **Drill-down MIS** and **Monthly MIS** (top right)

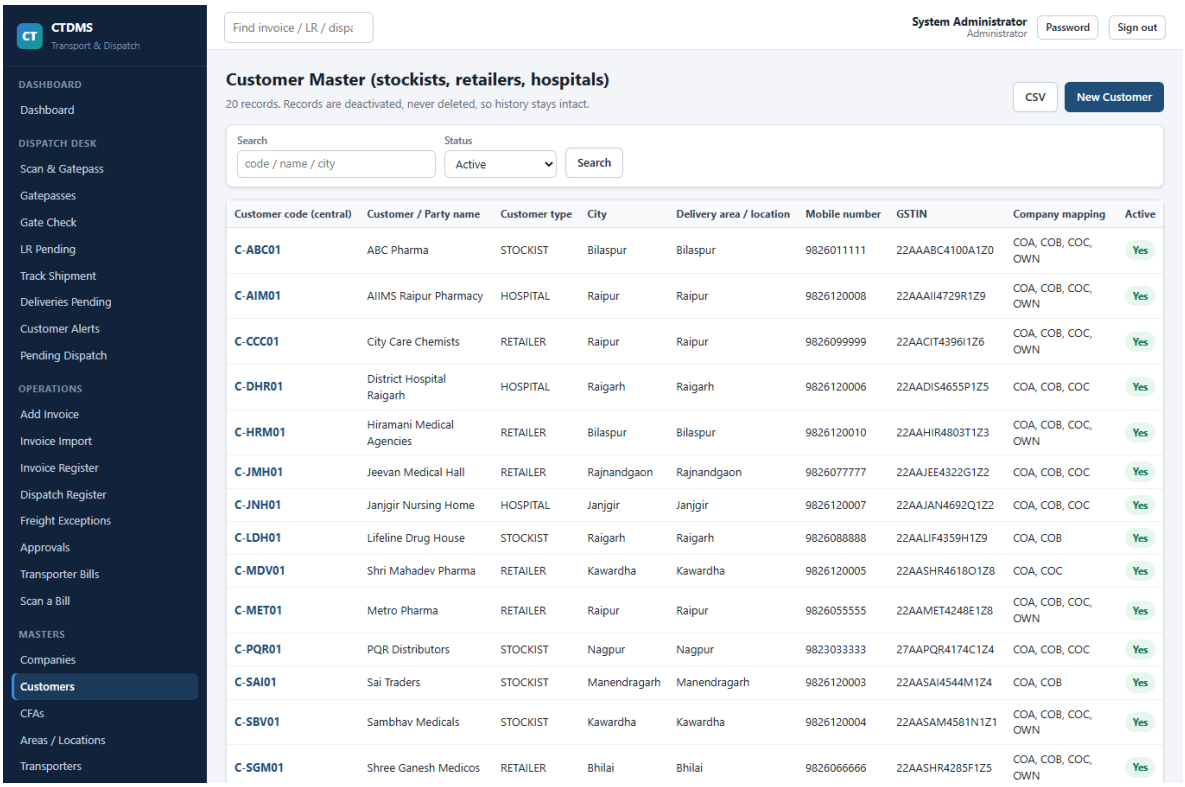
open the detailed MIS screen.

4. Setting up the system (do this first)

A new installation needs its master data before invoices can flow. Do the steps **in this order**; each step needs the one before it. The Master works under **Masters** in the menu.

Order	Screen	What to enter	Why it matters
1	Companies	Each principal (Company A, B …) with its code and the ERP it uses.	Every invoice belongs to a company.
2	CFAs	Each CFA warehouse (Raipur, Bilaspur, Durg …).	Gatepass numbers and user data scope depend on it.
3	Areas / Locations	Every town you deliver to.	Freight is priced per area.
4	Customers	Stockists, retailers, hospitals: name, area, mobile, WhatsApp, GSTIN, type.	Invoices are matched to customers by code or GSTIN.
5	Transporters	Name, contact, GST, payment mode (CASH or TBB = bill later).	Gatepasses and bills point to a transporter.
6	Transporter Rate Cards	Rate per case for each area, per transporter.	Gives the freight on every gatepass.
7	Outside Autos	Hired autos used for local delivery.	Per-trip or per-case charges.
8	ERP Mappings / Integration Settings	How each ERP names its customers and columns.	Lets imports run without correction.
9	Users and Roles	Staff logins and what each may do.	Nobody else can work until this is done.

4.1 Master records (Companies, CFAs, Locations, Customers, Transporters, Autos)

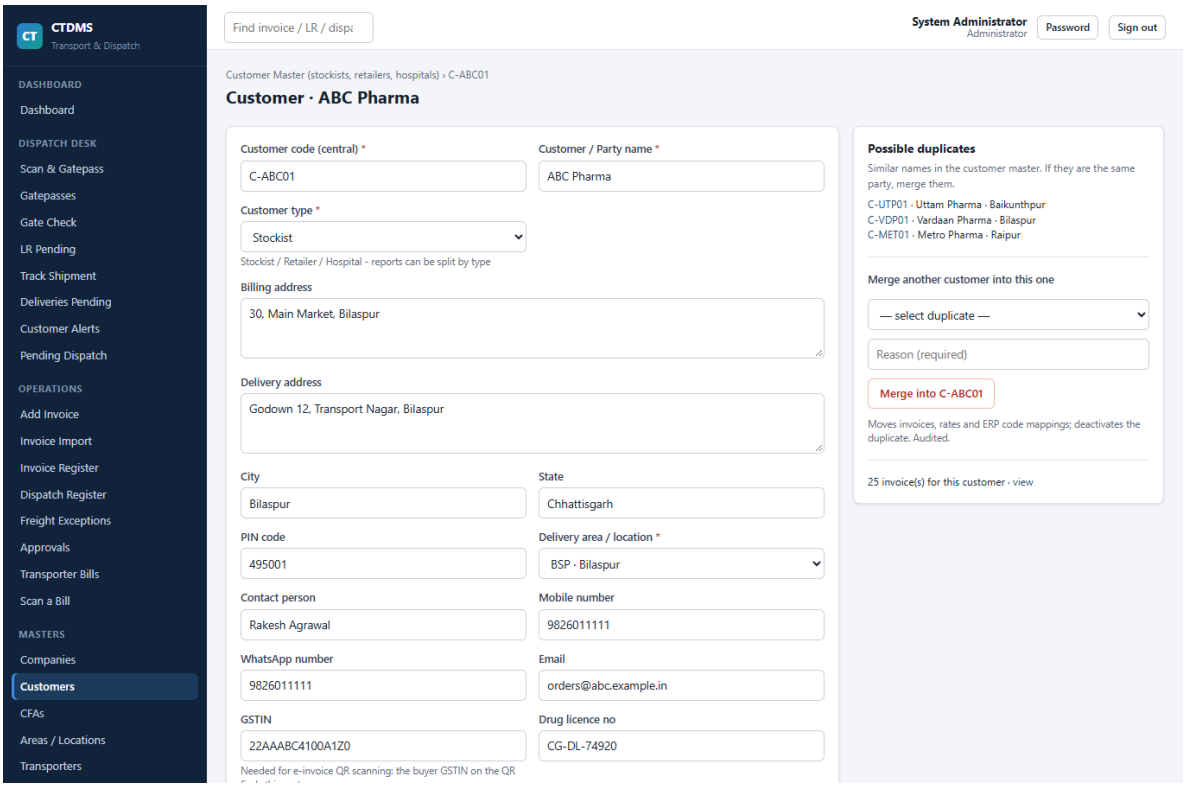


Customer master list. The other masters work the same way.

Every master screen has the same pattern: a list with a search box, a **New** button, and a click on a row to edit. Required fields are marked with a red star. Every create and edit is written to the audit log with the old and new values.

CAUTION Never delete a record that has been used. Make it **inactive** (untick Active) instead; old invoices keep their history.

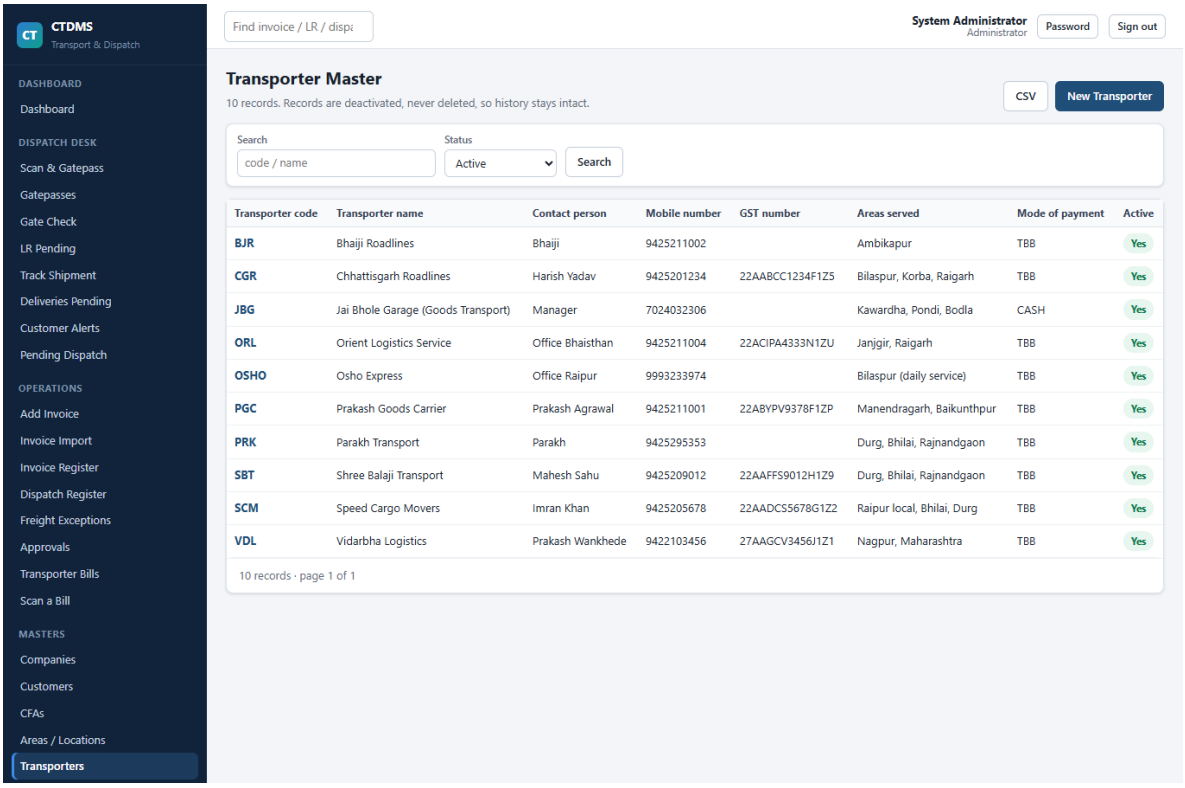
Customers: ERP codes and duplicates



One customer can have a different code in each ERP. All map to one central record.

- **Add ERP code** links another ERP's code for the same customer, so the next import is recognised automatically.
- **Possible duplicates** lists customers that look the same. **Merge into ...** moves all invoices, rates and codes to one record. Merging cannot be undone, so check the names and GSTIN first.

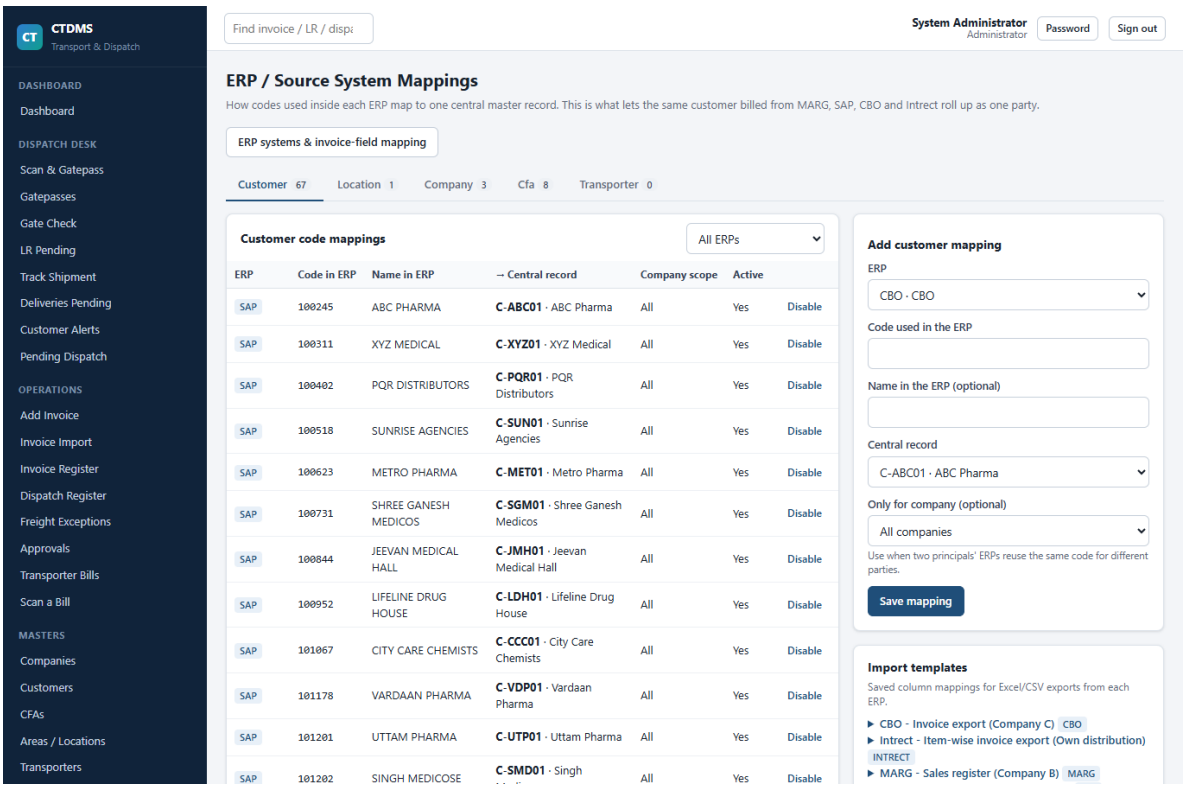
Transporters



Transporter master with payment mode (CASH or TBB).

CASH transporters (and outside autos) are marked paid in full when a gatepass is made. **TBB** (to be billed) transporters send a bill later, which is checked under Transporter Bills.

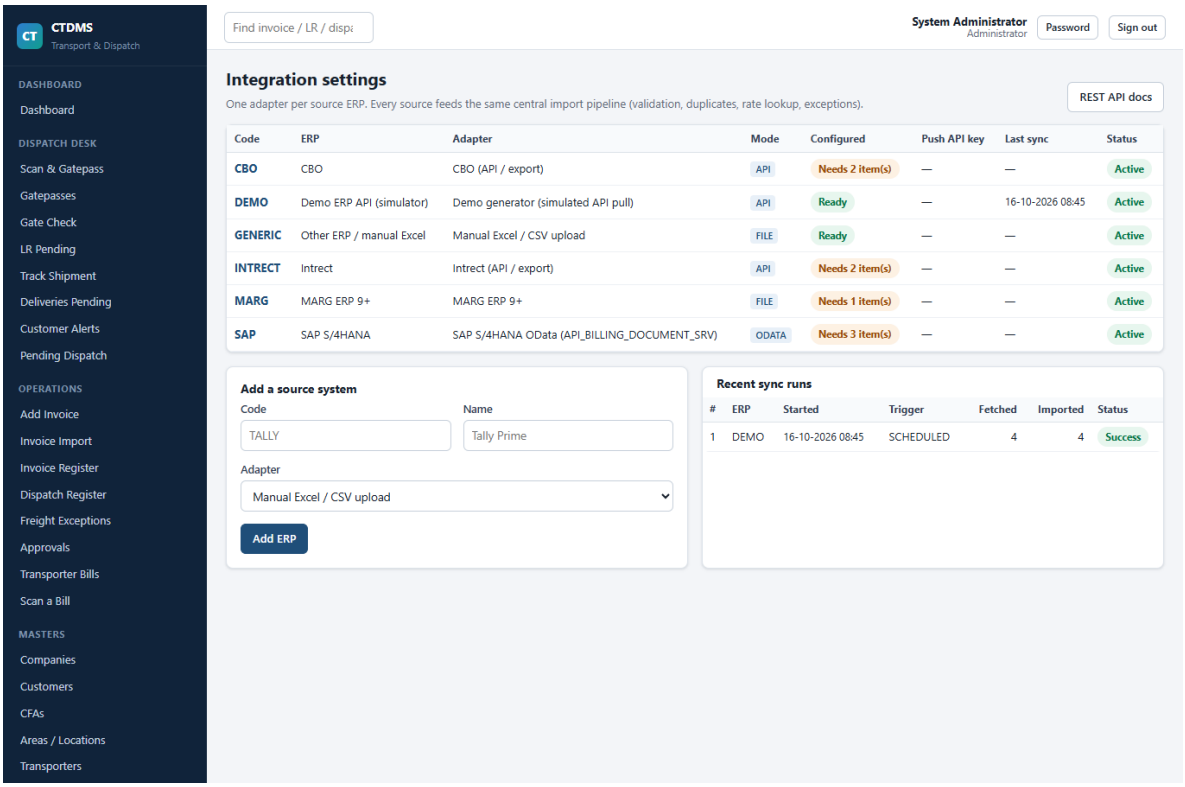
4.2 ERP mappings



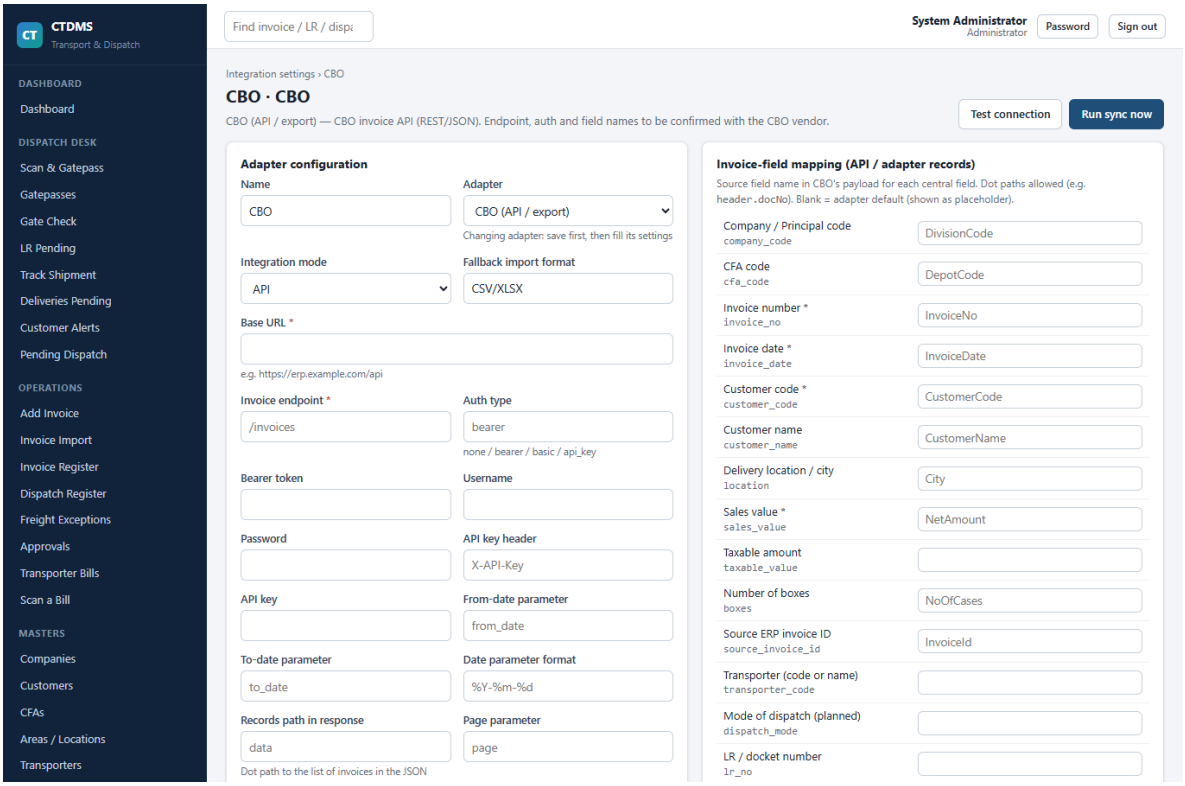
ERP customer-code mapping.

Each ERP calls the same customer by a different code. Here the Master (or CFA Manager) maps those codes once. The Invoice Import screen can also create a mapping on the spot when it meets an unknown code.

4.3 Integration settings (ERP connections)



Integration settings: one line per ERP, with recent sync runs.



One ERP: adapter configuration, field mapping, push API key and sync history.

- **Add ERP** creates a new source system. **Adapter configuration** holds its connection details; **Test connection** checks them; **Run sync now** pulls invoices straight away.
- **Invoice-field mapping** says which ERP field means invoice number, date, amount, cases and so on.
- **Generate API key** lets the ERP push invoices to CTDMS. The key is shown **once**; copy it then. Generating a new key stops the old one.

- **REST API docs** (top right) lists the technical calls for your IT person.

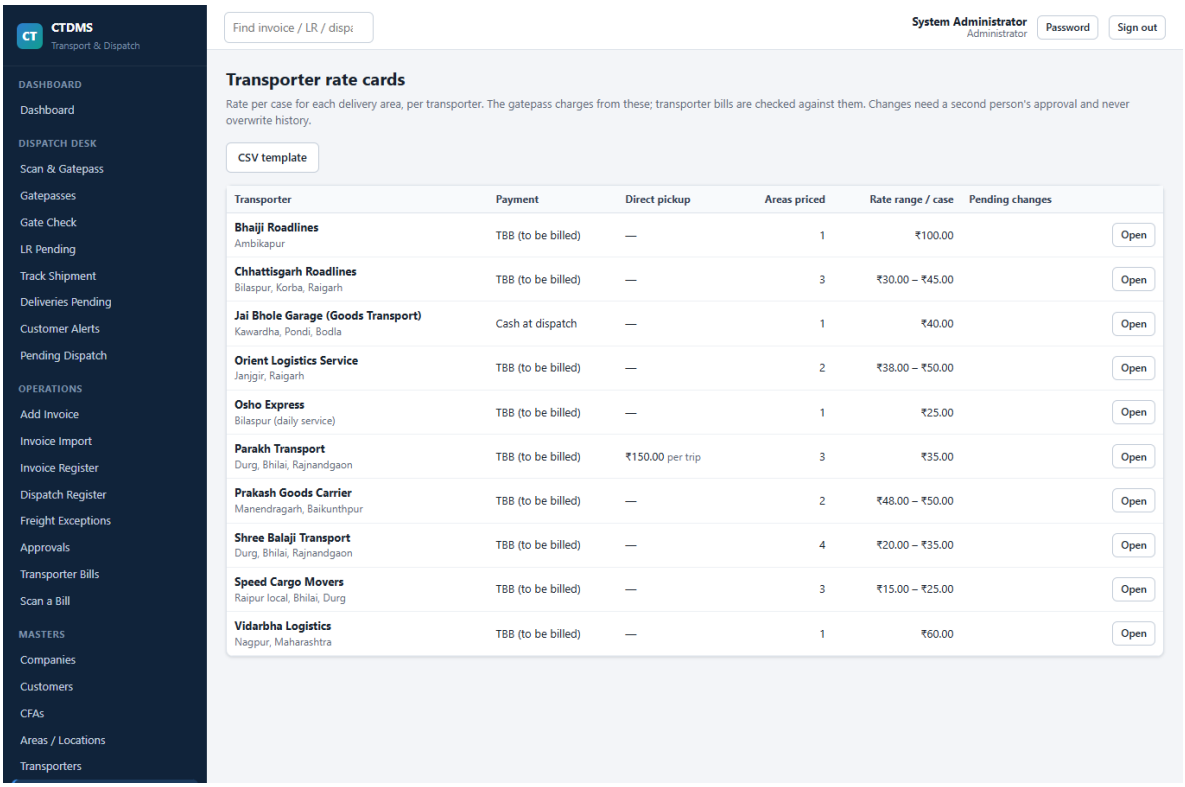
TIP You do not need ERP access for CTDMS to work. File import, the drop folder and QR scanning need no connection at all.

5. Freight rates

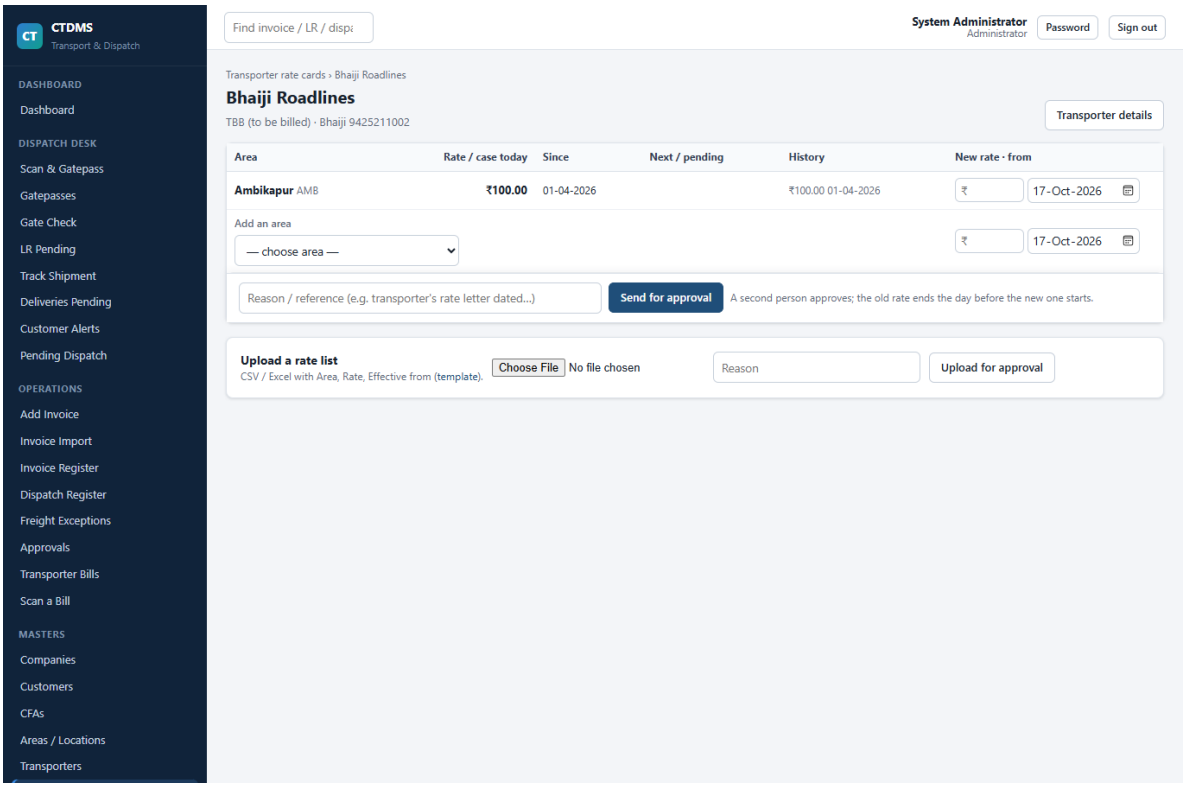
There are two kinds of rate in CTDMS. Which one is used is a Master setting (**freight.source** in System Settings).

Rate type	Where	Used when
Transporter rate card (default)	Masters › Transporter Rate Cards	Freight per case for each area for each transporter. Applied when the gatepass is made.
Principal freight rate	Masters › Principal Freight Rates	Rate set by company + CFA + location (+ optional customer), with effective dates. Used when freight.source = COMPANY.

5.1 Transporter rate cards



List of transporters and the state of their rate cards.

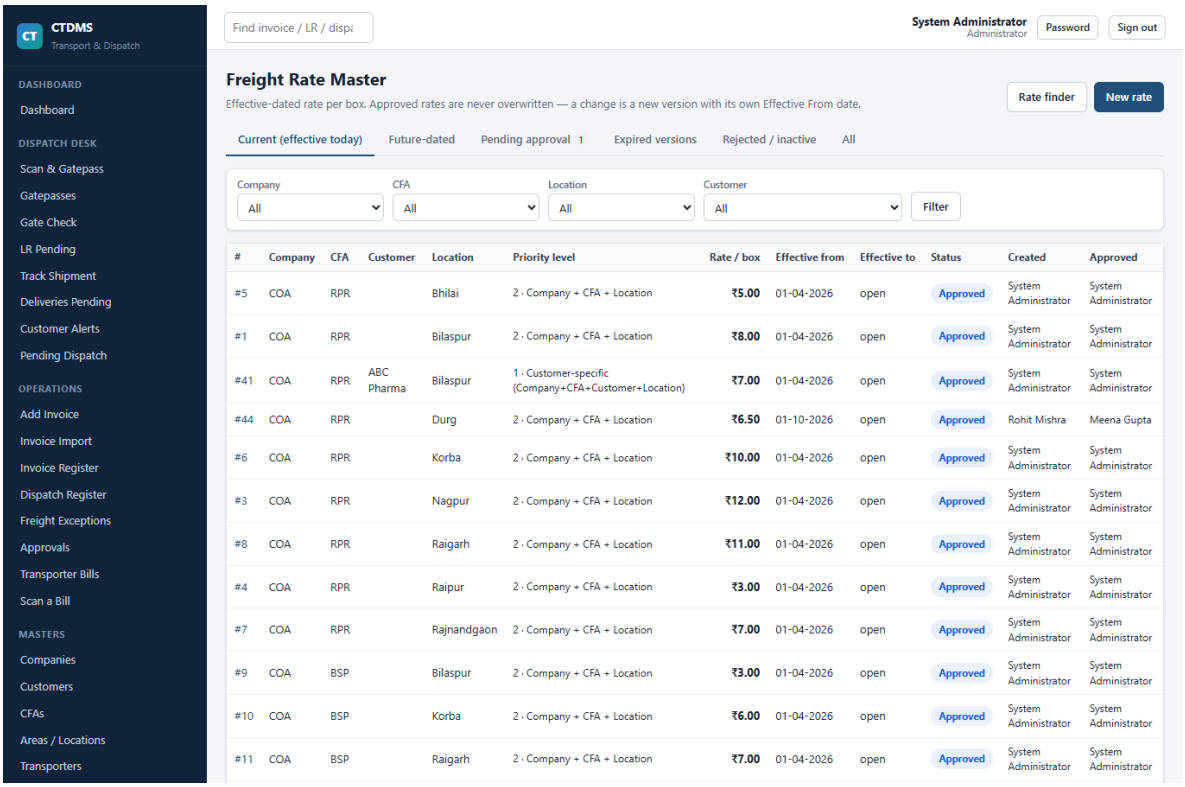


One transporter's rate card.

1. Open a transporter. Type the new rate for each area and an **Effective From** date.
2. Press **Send for approval**. A second person (Checker) approves it under Approvals. Only then is it used.
3. To load a whole list, download *template.csv*, fill it, and press **Upload for approval**.

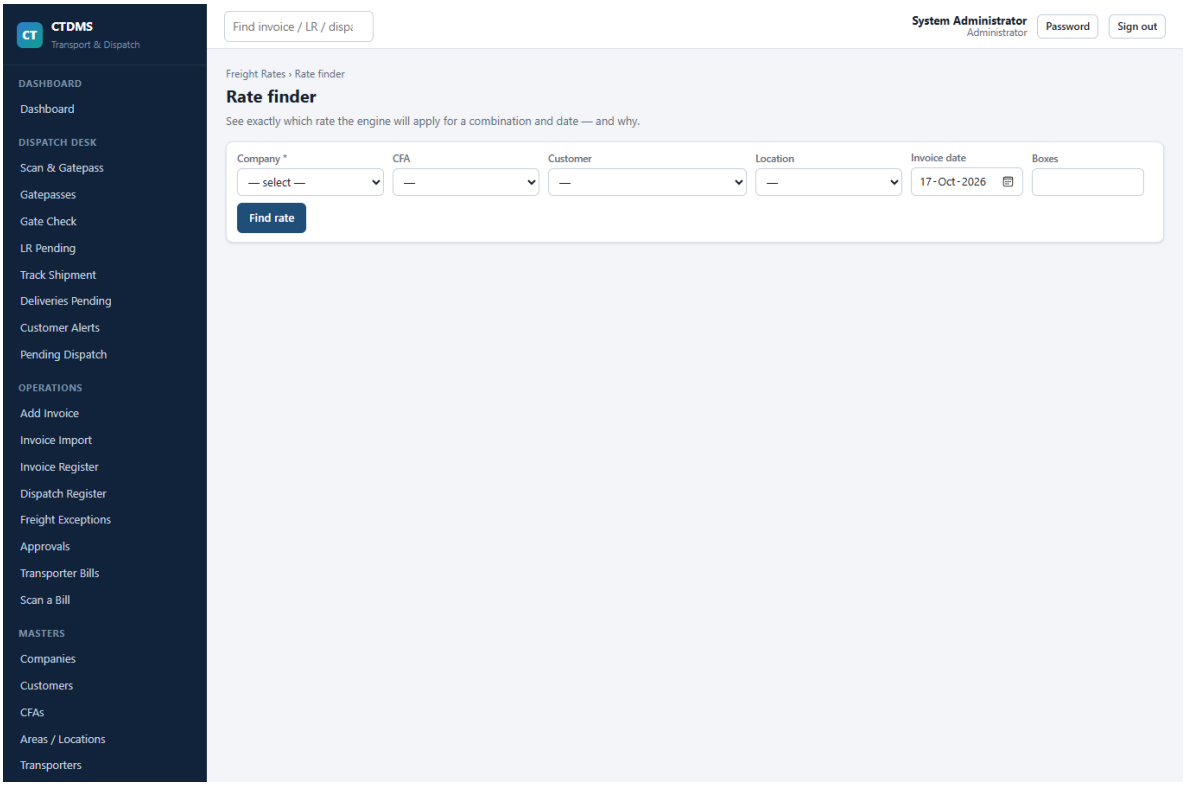
TIP Old gatepasses keep the rate they were made with. A new rate only affects gatepasses made on or after its effective date.

5.2 Principal freight rates



Freight Rate Master with filters and bulk upload.

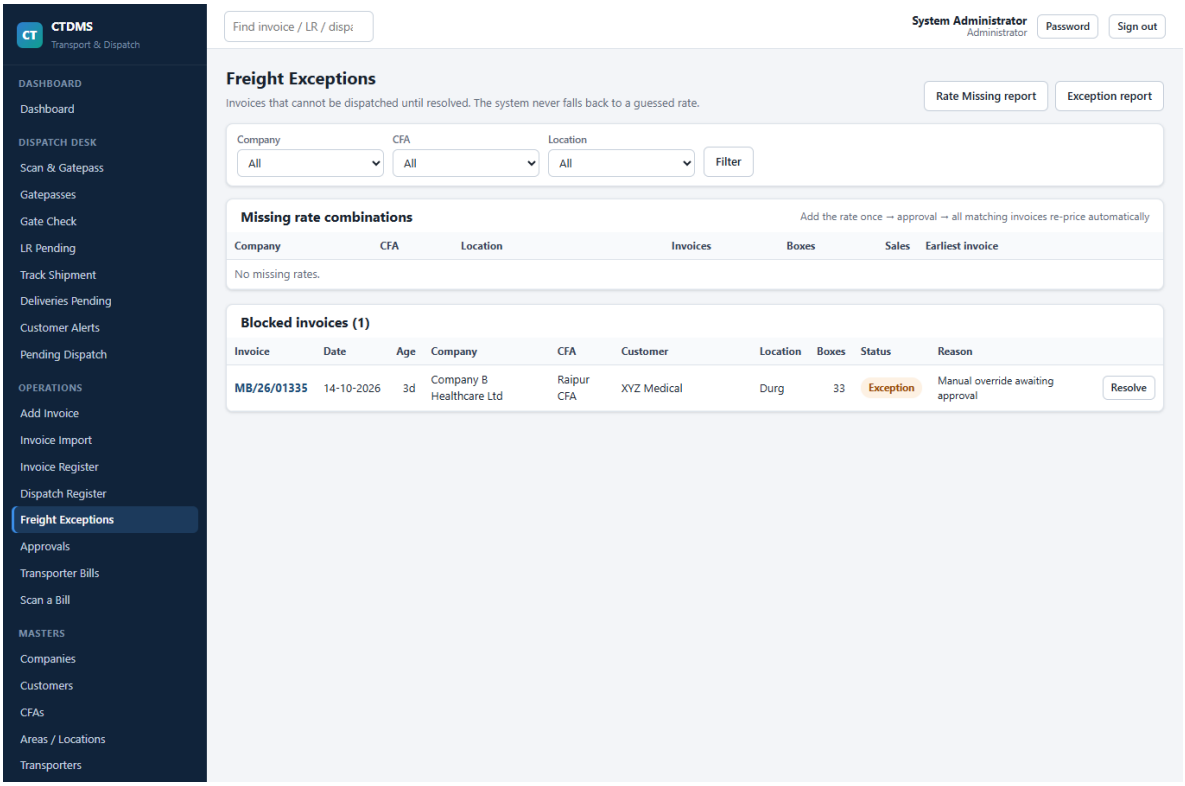
- **New rate**: choose company, CFA, location, optionally a customer, the rate per box and the start date.
- **Revise** a rate: the old one is closed on the day before and the new one starts. History is kept.
- **Close** a rate when it no longer applies. **Rate finder** answers 'what rate would apply to this company / customer / place on this date?'.
- **Upload** loads many rates from Excel or CSV.



Rate finder.

5.3 When a rate is missing

If an invoice has no rate it is not guessed: it becomes **RATE MISSING** and is listed under **Operations › Freight Exceptions** with the exact combination missing.



Freight Exceptions: missing rate combinations and blocked invoices.

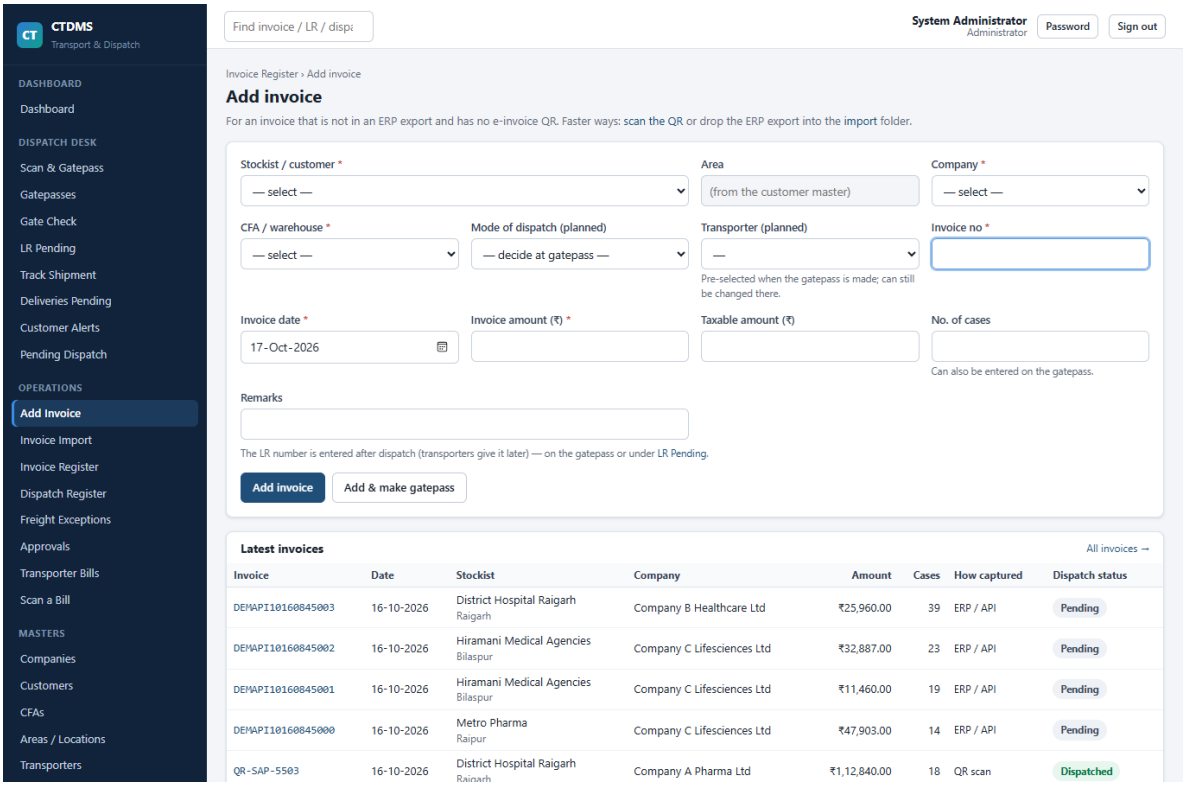
1. Add (and get approved) the missing rate.
2. With **rate.auto_resolve_missing** on, the waiting invoices are priced automatically; otherwise open the invoice and press **Recalculate**.
3. Use **Resolve** on a blocked invoice after fixing its cause.

6. Getting invoices into CTDMS

There are four ways in. All of them apply the same checks (duplicates, company and CFA scope, customer and area).

Way	Best for	How
Scan the e-invoice QR	Warehouse desk, one invoice at a time	Dispatch desk › Scan & Gatepass (see chapter 7).
Add Invoice	A single invoice typed by hand	Operations › Add Invoice.
Drop folder	Daily ERP export, no clicks	ERP saves its export into **data/inbox** (or data/inbox/ERP-code). CTDMS reads it every 5 minutes.
Upload a file	Any export file	Operations › Invoice Import › One-click import.

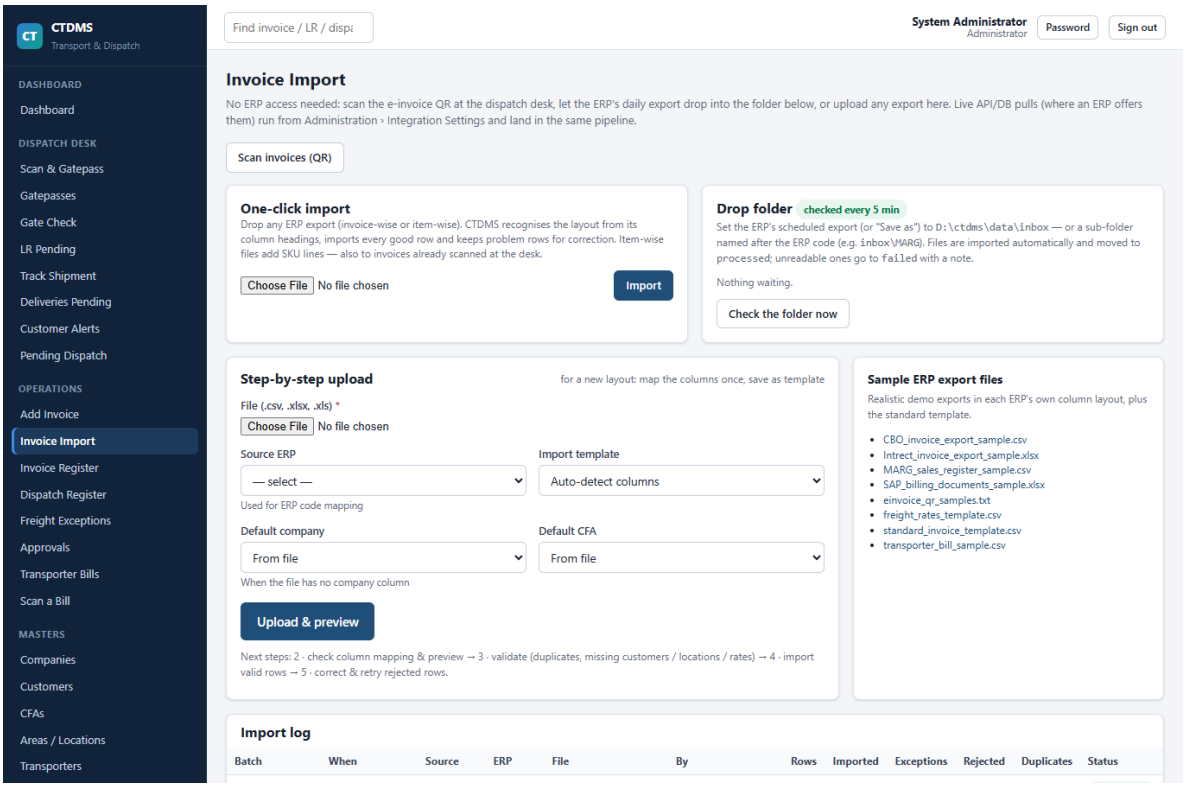
6.1 Add Invoice



Add Invoice: stockist, company, number, date, amount, taxable amount, cases, planned mode and transporter.

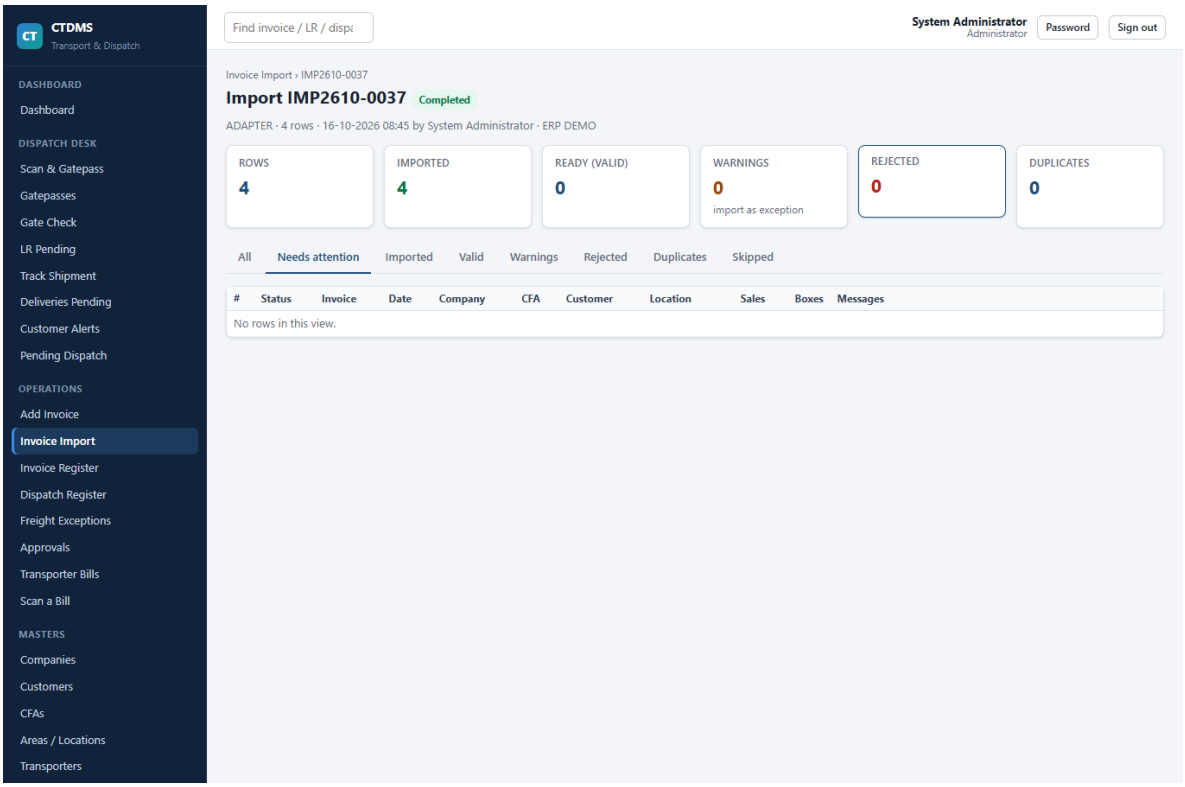
Choose the stockist (the area fills in), the company, then invoice number, date, amount, taxable amount and cases. Optionally set the planned mode of dispatch and transporter; they are pre-selected when the gatepass is made.

6.2 Invoice Import



Invoice Import: one-click import, drop folder, step-by-step upload, sample files, import log.

1. Drop any ERP export onto **One-click import** and press **Import**. The layout (SAP, MARG, CBO, Intrect or your own) is recognised from the column headings.
2. Use **Step-by-step upload** → **Upload & preview** when you want to see the rows before they are saved.
3. **Check the folder now** does not wait for the 5-minute timer.
4. Item-wise exports (one row per medicine) become one invoice with its SKU lines.
5. The **Import log** lists every batch and its result.



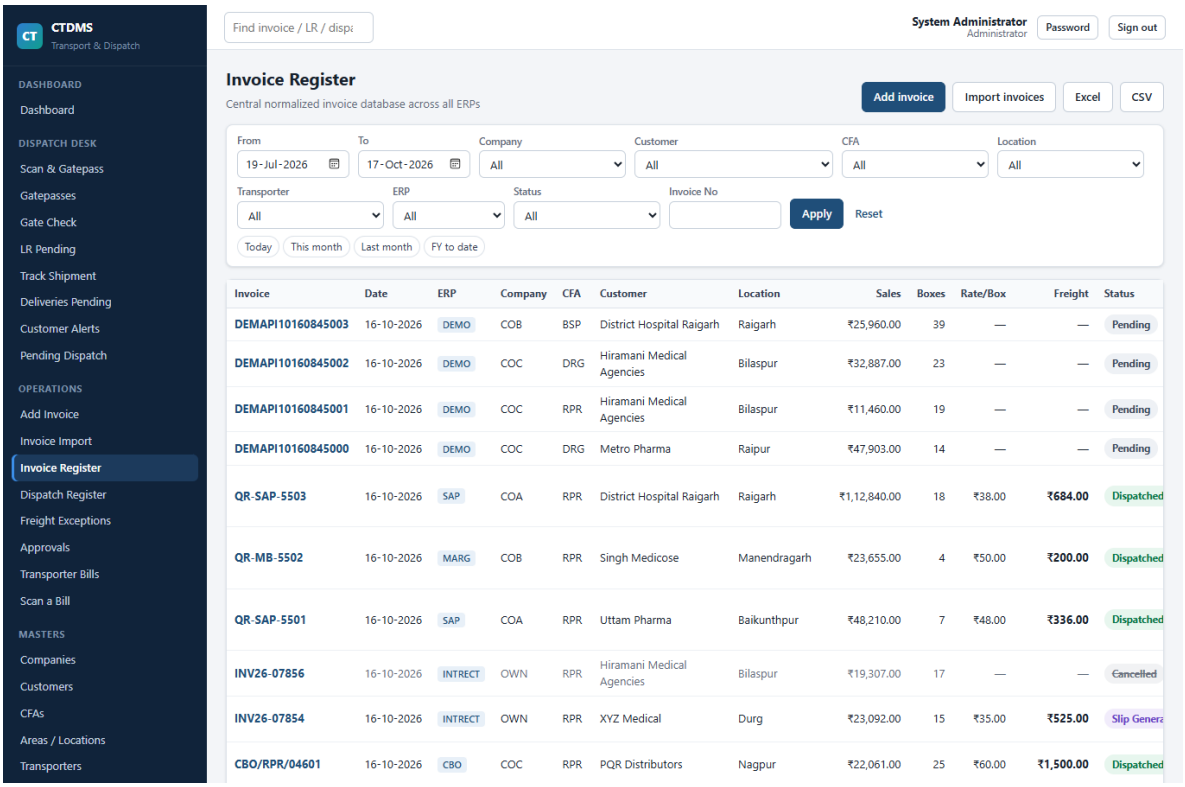
One import batch with its rows and problems.

Problems on import and how to fix them

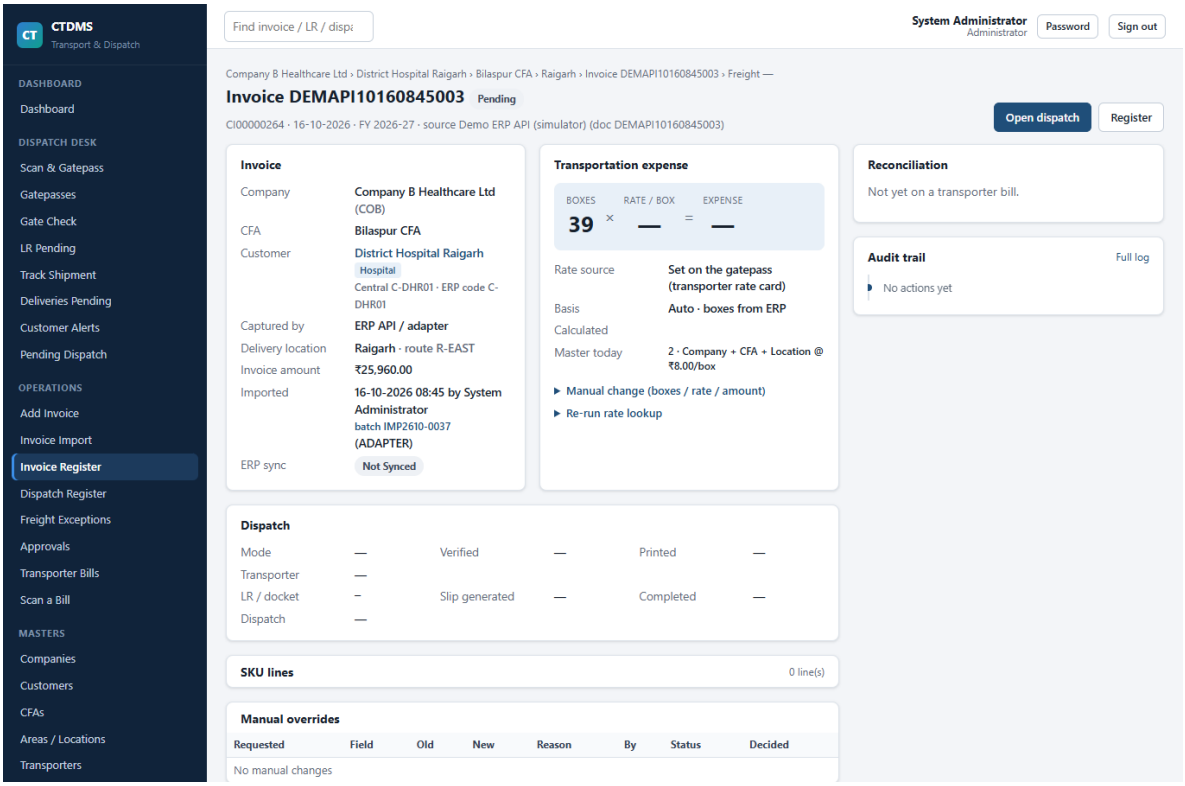
Message / problem	What it means	What to do
Unknown customer	The ERP code is not mapped.	Map it to an existing customer, or create the customer, then press **Retry**.
Code typo	The code is nearly the same as a known one.	Correct the row in the batch and Retry.
Unknown location / area	The town does not exist in Locations.	Add the location (Masters) and Retry.
Blank boxes	No case count in the file.	Type the cases in the row. If **import.allow_blank_boxes** is on, the invoice lands as an EXCEPTION until fixed.
Duplicate	This invoice number is already in CTDMS.	Skip the row. It is never stored twice.
Whole file rejected / unknown layout	Headings not recognised.	Map the columns once under *Mapping*; it is saved as a template for next time.

TIP Press **Cancel** on a batch to throw it away before it is committed. Nothing from it is saved.

6.3 Invoice Register



Invoice Register with filters and status.

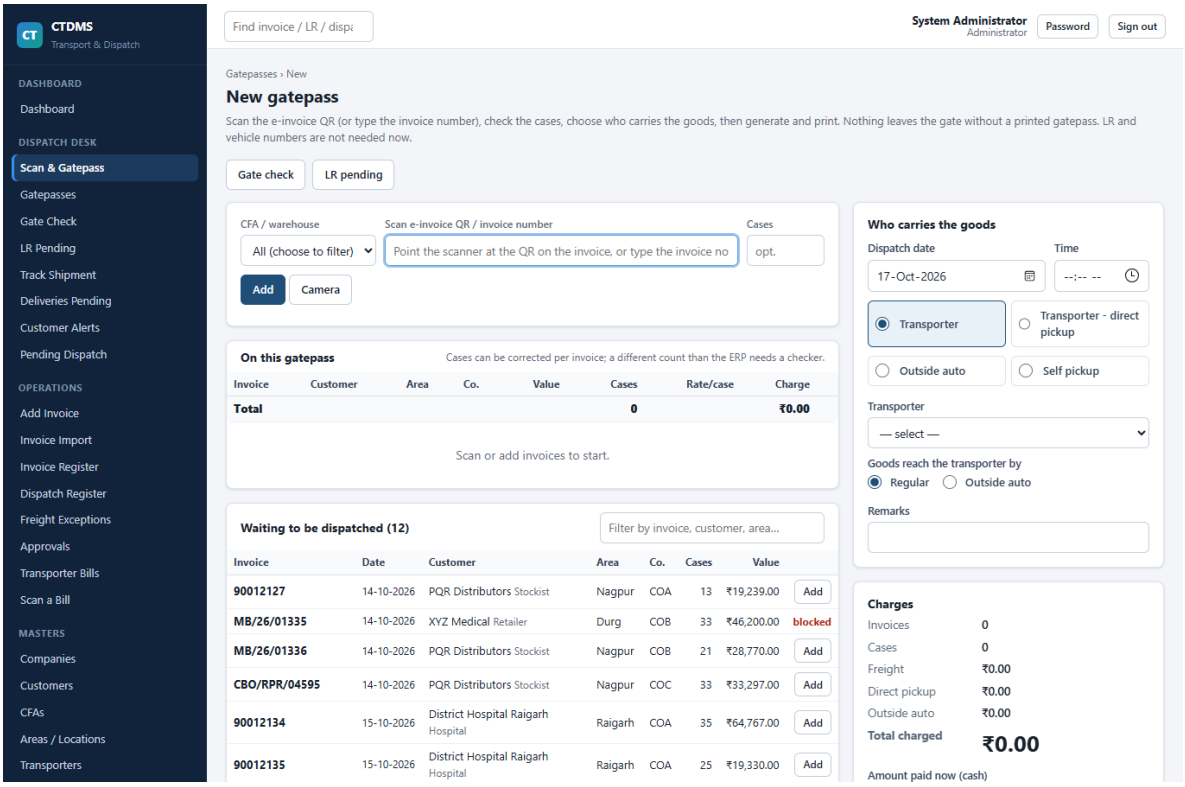


One invoice: freight calculation, dispatch, SKU lines, overrides, slips, prints, reconciliation and full audit trail.

Click any invoice to see everything about it, including who did what and when (**Audit trail**). **Recalculate** reprices an open invoice after a rate change. **Override** requests a manual change of cases or freight (see chapter 9).

7. Dispatch desk: from gatepass to delivery

7.1 Scan & Gatepass (making a gatepass)

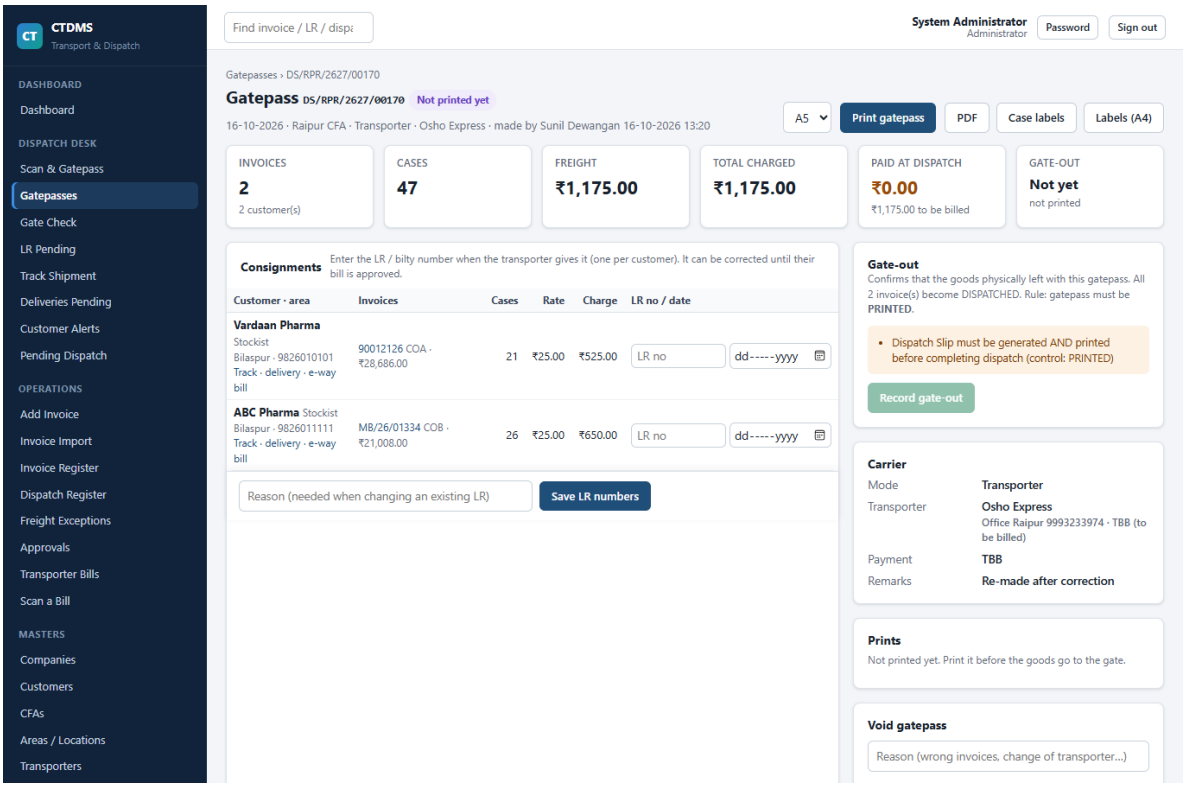


New gatepass: scan or add invoices, choose who carries the goods, see charges.

1. Scan the e-invoice QR with the barcode scanner (or type the invoice number and press Enter). An invoice not yet in CTDMS is created from the QR. Invoices waiting to be dispatched are listed on the same screen; press **Add** to include them. **Camera** scans with a phone camera.
2. Check the **cases** for each invoice. A count different from the ERP's needs a checker.
3. Choose **who carries the goods**: Transporter, Transporter – direct pickup, Outside auto, or Self pickup.
4. Read the **Charges** panel: freight, extras, total charged, and amount paid now (cash for autos and CASH transporters).
5. Press **Generate gatepass**. One number now covers the whole pickup.

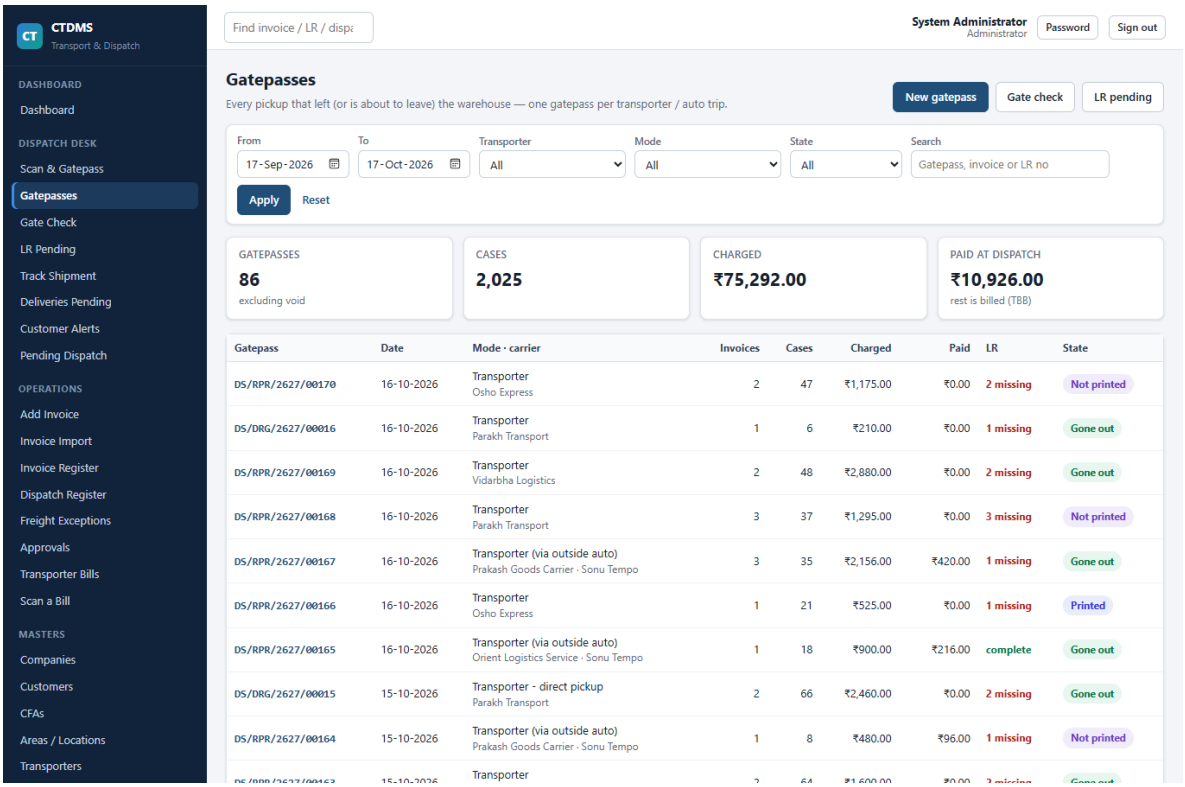
PROBLEM An invoice whose area has no rate on the chosen transporter's card is flagged. Add the rate under Transporter Rate Cards first (a second person approves it).

7.2 The gatepass page



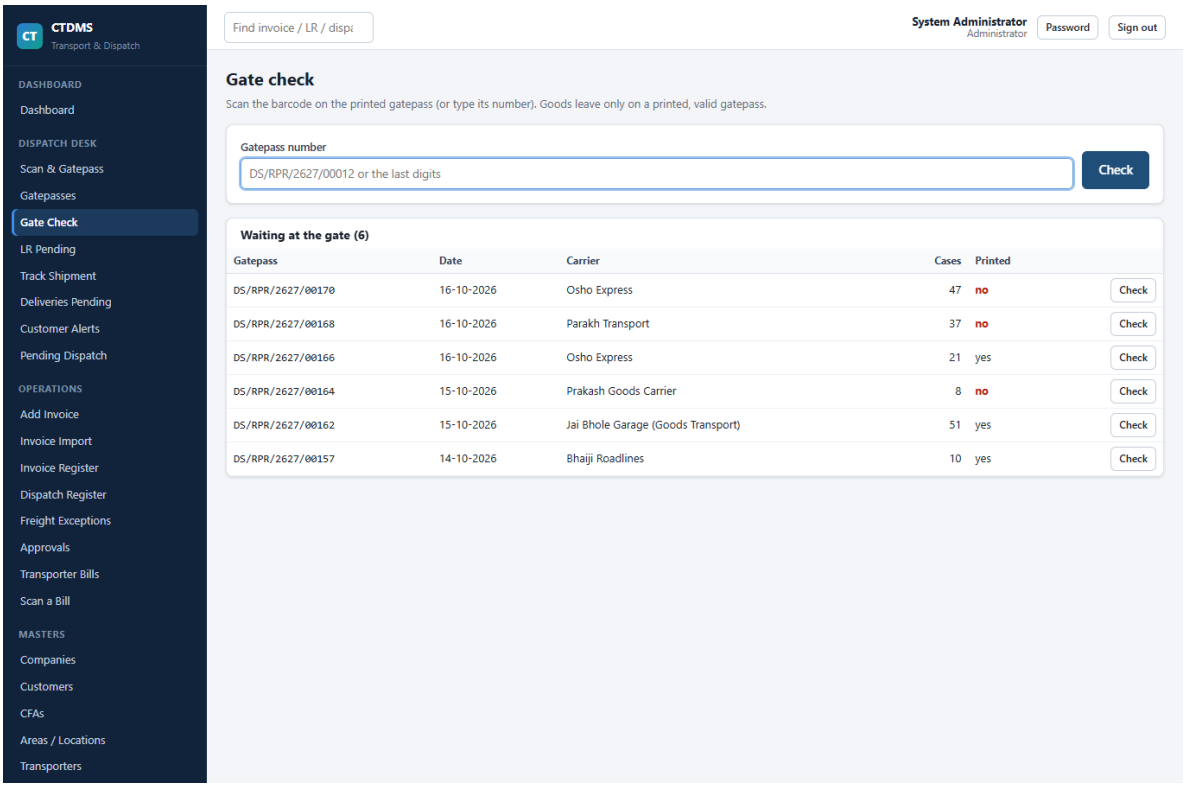
A gatepass: consignments, LR numbers, gate-out, carrier, prints and void.

- **Print gatepass** (A5, A4 or PDF) prints the barcode, every customer with invoices, cases and charge, and the transporter details. It must be printed before gate-out.
- **Case labels**: one label per case (100 × 50 mm label printer or A4 sheets). Scanning any label at the gate opens the gatepass.
- **LR numbers**: type one per customer when the transporter gives it. They can be corrected, with a reason, until the transporter's bill is approved.
- **Reprints** need a reason and are stamped REPRINT #n (DUPLICATE).
- **Void** a wrong gatepass (reason required) before gate-out; the invoices go back to the queue and a new gatepass gets a new number.



Gatepass list with totals.

7.3 Gate Check (the guard)

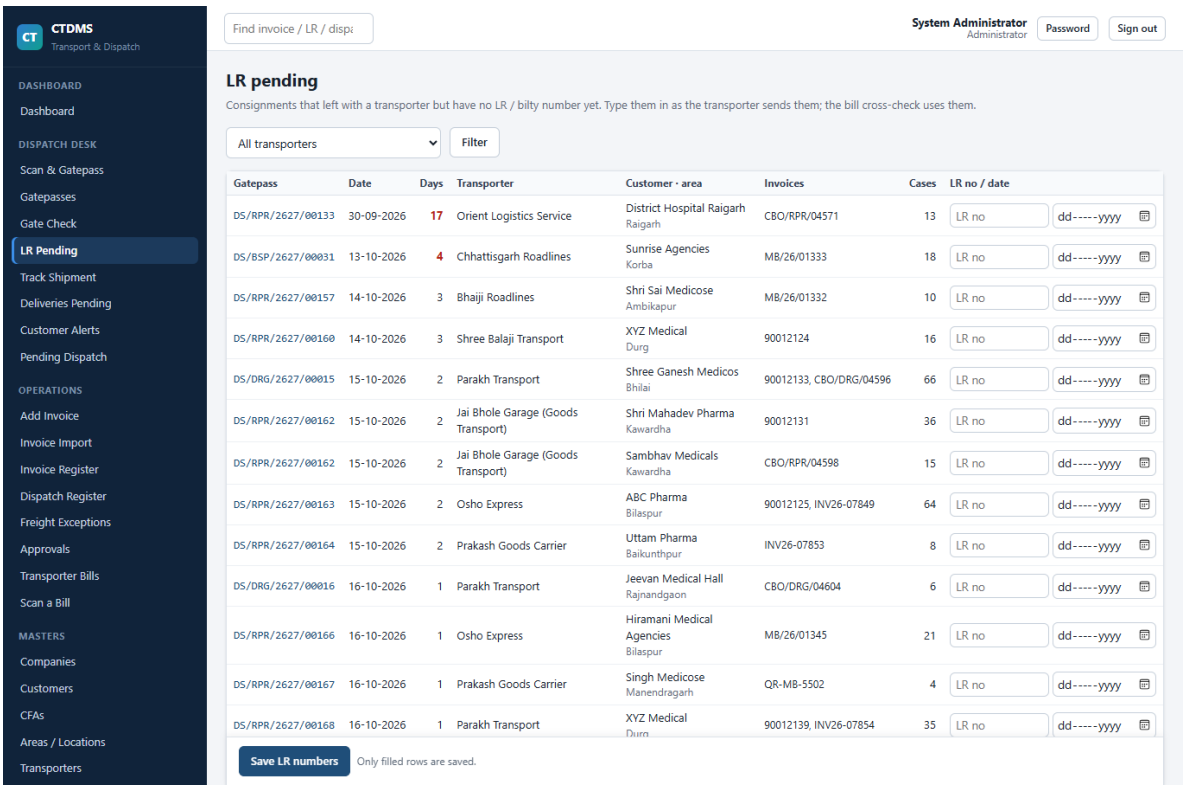


Gate Check: scan the gatepass barcode, count the cases, confirm.

The guard scans the gatepass barcode, counts the cases and presses **Confirm gate-out**. All the invoices become DISPATCHED. A void, unprinted or already-used gatepass shows a red **STOP**.

Gate problem	Cause	Fix
Red STOP: not printed	Gatepass was generated but never printed.	Print it, then scan again.
Red STOP: void	A checker voided it.	Find the replacement gatepass number.
Red STOP: already used	It already went out.	Do not release the goods again. Check Gatepass Register.
Refused: e-way bill needed	**gate.eway_required_above** is set and the invoice is above it.	Enter a valid 12-digit e-way bill on the consignment's Track page.

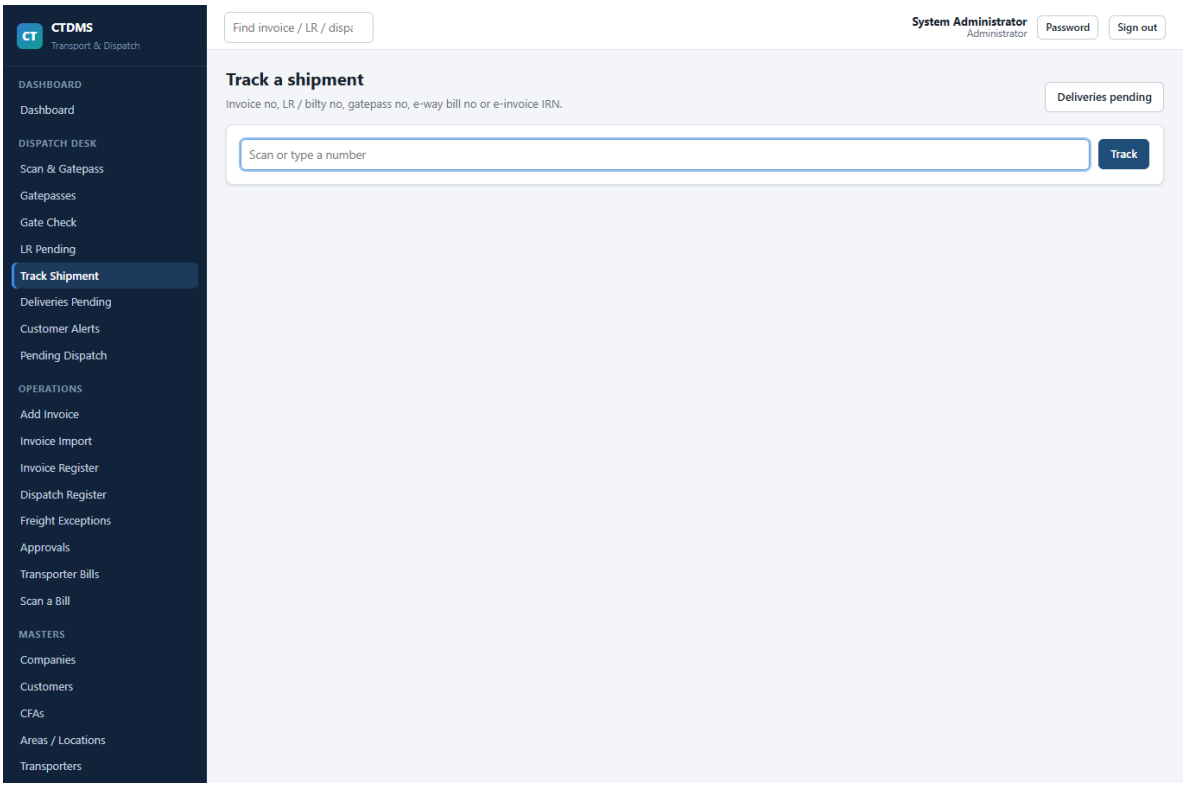
7.4 LR Pending



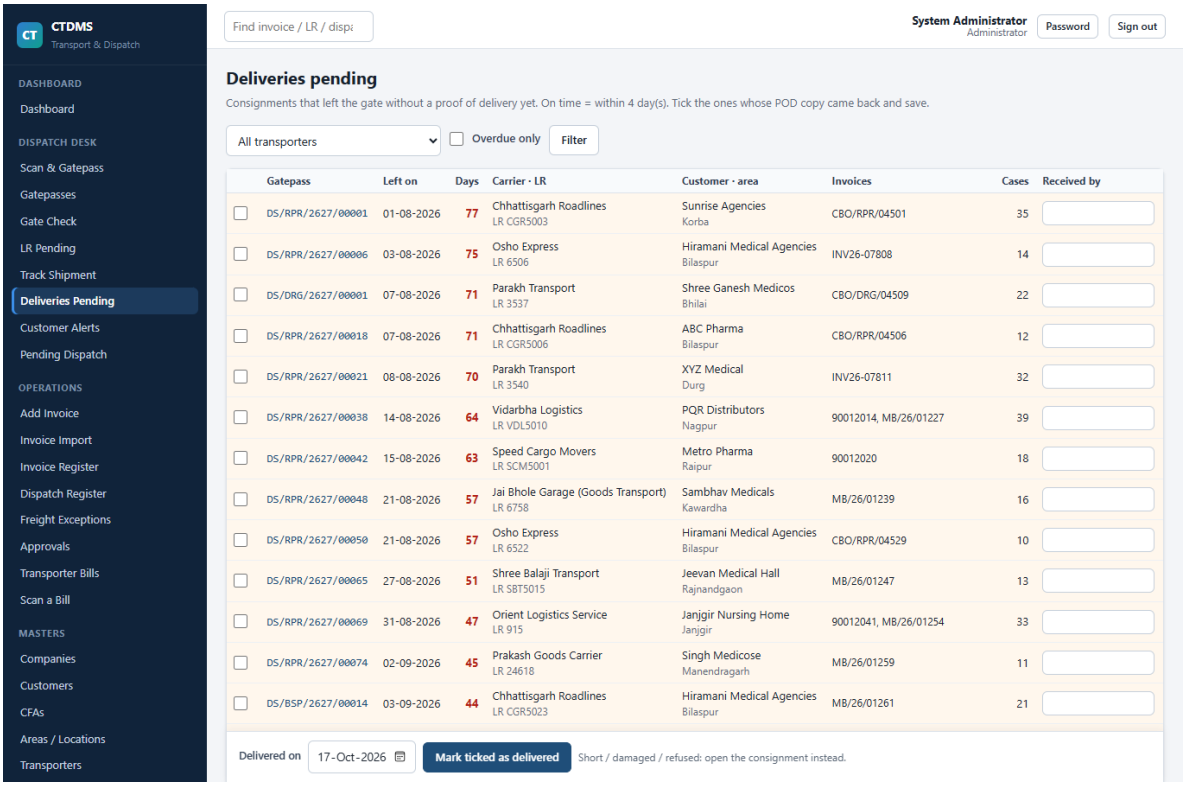
Consignments that left the gate without an LR number.

Enter LR numbers in bulk here as the transporters send them. Each customer on a gatepass has its own LR.

7.5 Track Shipment and proof of delivery



Track a shipment: search any invoice, LR, gatepass, e-way bill or IRN number.

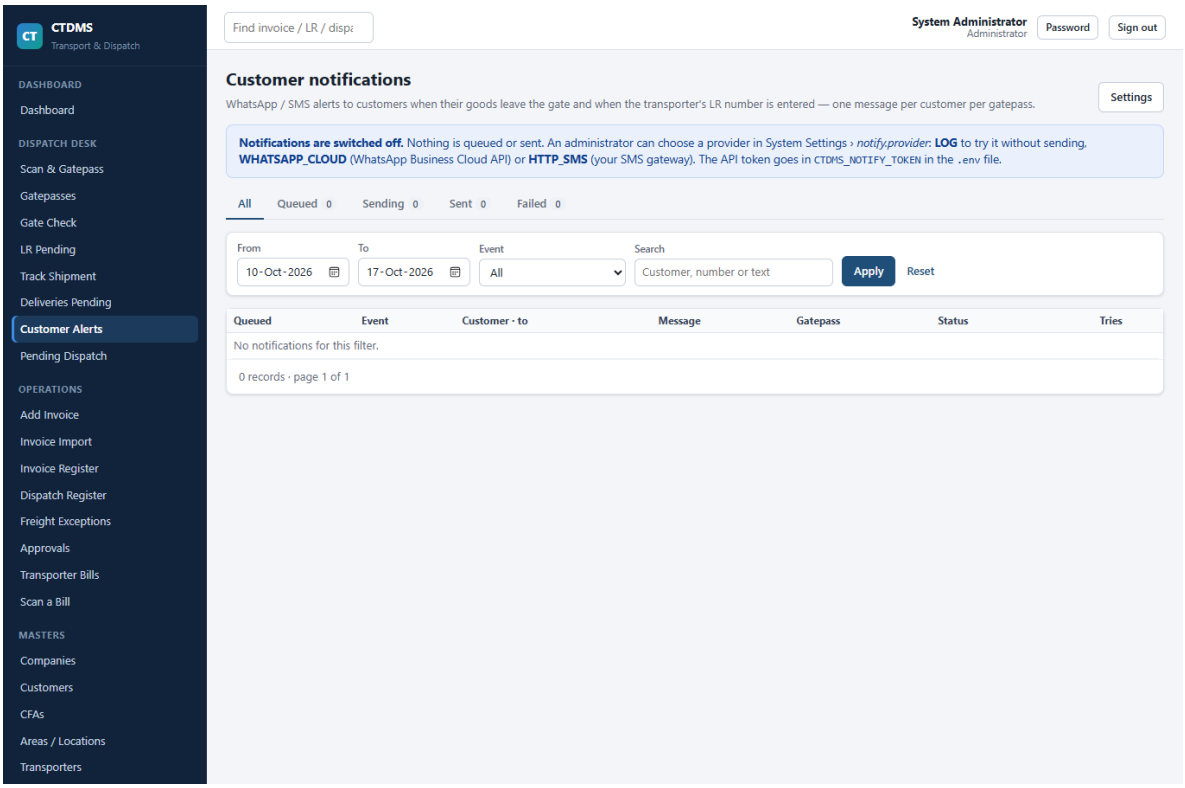


Deliveries Pending: consignments awaiting proof of delivery; overdue ones are highlighted.

- **Track** shows the full timeline: order received → gatepass → printed → left warehouse → LR → delivered → bill checked → paid.
- On **Deliveries Pending** tick consignments and press **Mark ticked as delivered** with the date.
- For short, damaged or refused goods open the consignment, choose the result, write a note and attach a photo of the signed LR. A change to an existing result needs a reason.

- Consignments past **delivery.expected_days** are shown as overdue.

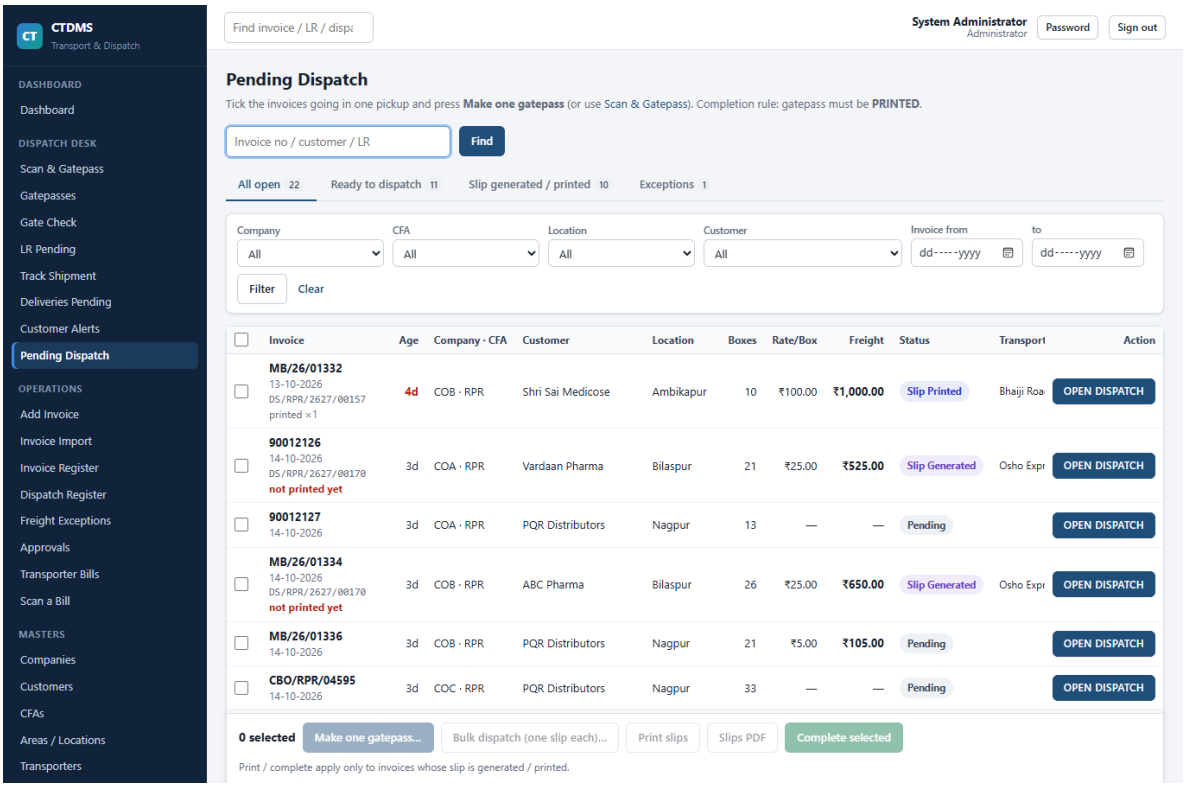
7.6 Customer Alerts



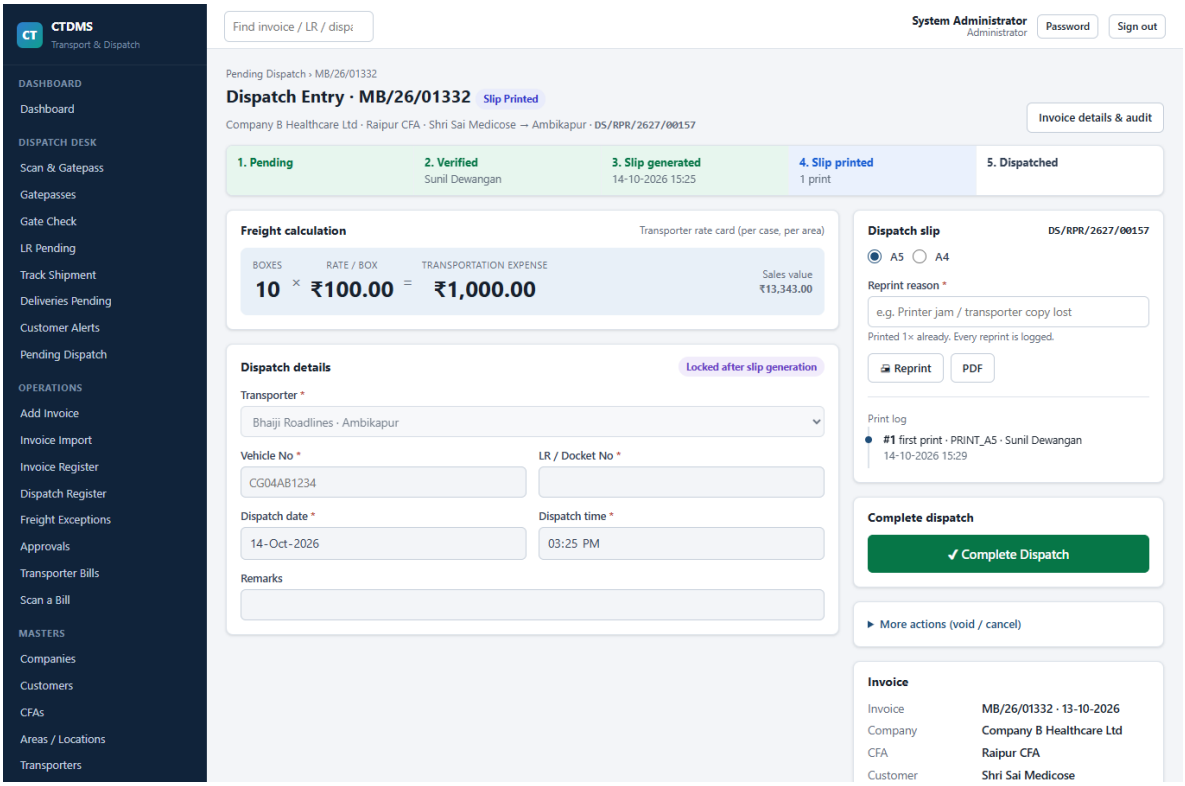
Customer alerts queue.

When switched on, customers are told when goods leave the gate and when the LR is entered, with a tracking link they can open to see the timeline and confirm receipt. WhatsApp and SMS sending are **paid services and are locked**. With the provider set to **LOG** the messages are prepared and shown here so you can check the wording, but nothing is sent.

7.7 Pending Dispatch and Dispatch Register



Pending Dispatch: invoices not yet dispatched.



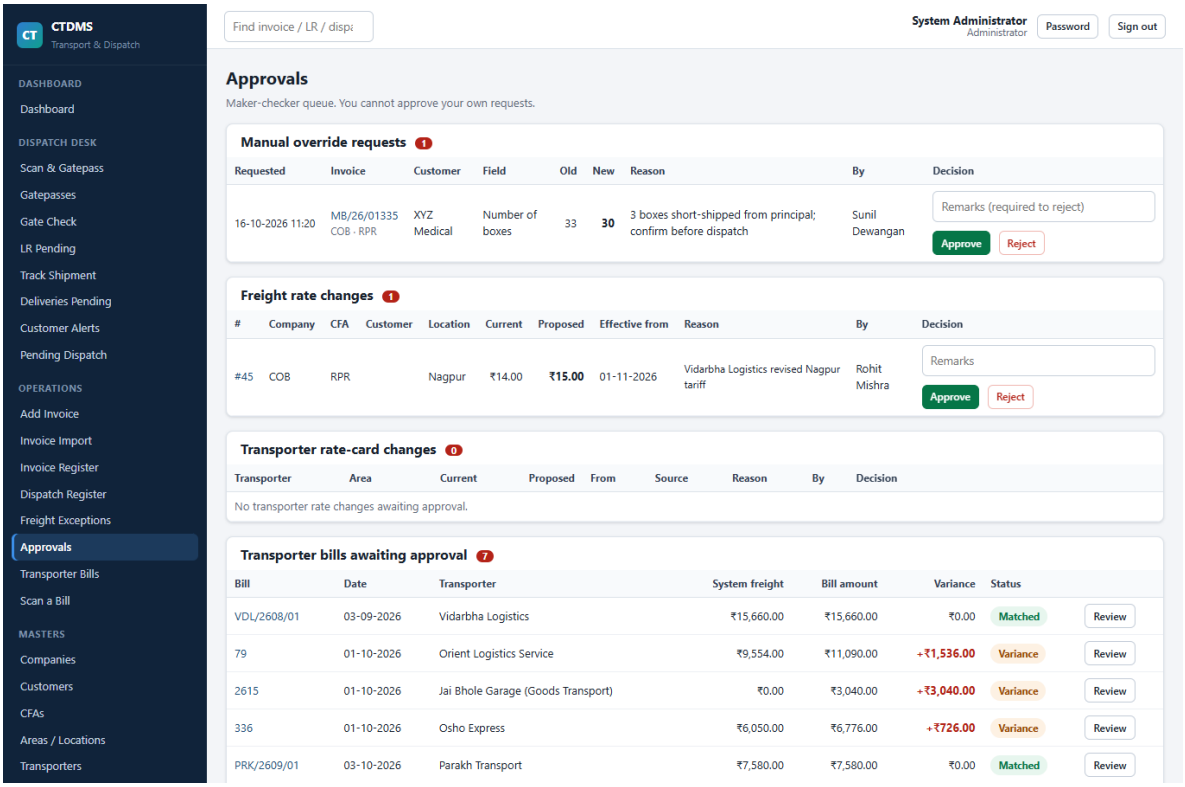
Dispatch entry for one invoice: freight calculation, slip, complete dispatch.

Pending Dispatch lists open invoices. Tick several and press **Make one gatepass**. Open a single invoice to see the freight calculation and, where used, to generate the dispatch slip and complete the dispatch. **Dispatch Register** lists all completed dispatches.

TIP Rules that the Master can switch on or off in System Settings: verify before slip, printed slip before completing, vehicle number mandatory, LR mandatory, reason for reprints, future dispatch dates. Each one is explained in chapter 11.

8. Approvals and overrides: the two-person rule

Money-affecting changes need a second person. The Master can approve anything except, by default, a request the Master made personally (see the self-approval settings).



Approvals: override requests, freight rate changes, rate-card changes and transporter bills.

Approval type	Raised by	Decision
Manual override (cases / rate / freight)	Operator or CFA Manager from the invoice page, with a reason.	**Approve** or **Reject**. Users with override.direct (Checker, Master) can apply it directly; it is still audited.
Freight rate change	Anyone with rate.create.	Approve before the rate can be used.
Transporter rate-card change	Rate card page.	Approve with its effective date.
Transporter bill	Accounts.	Approve for payment, or Reject with a reason.

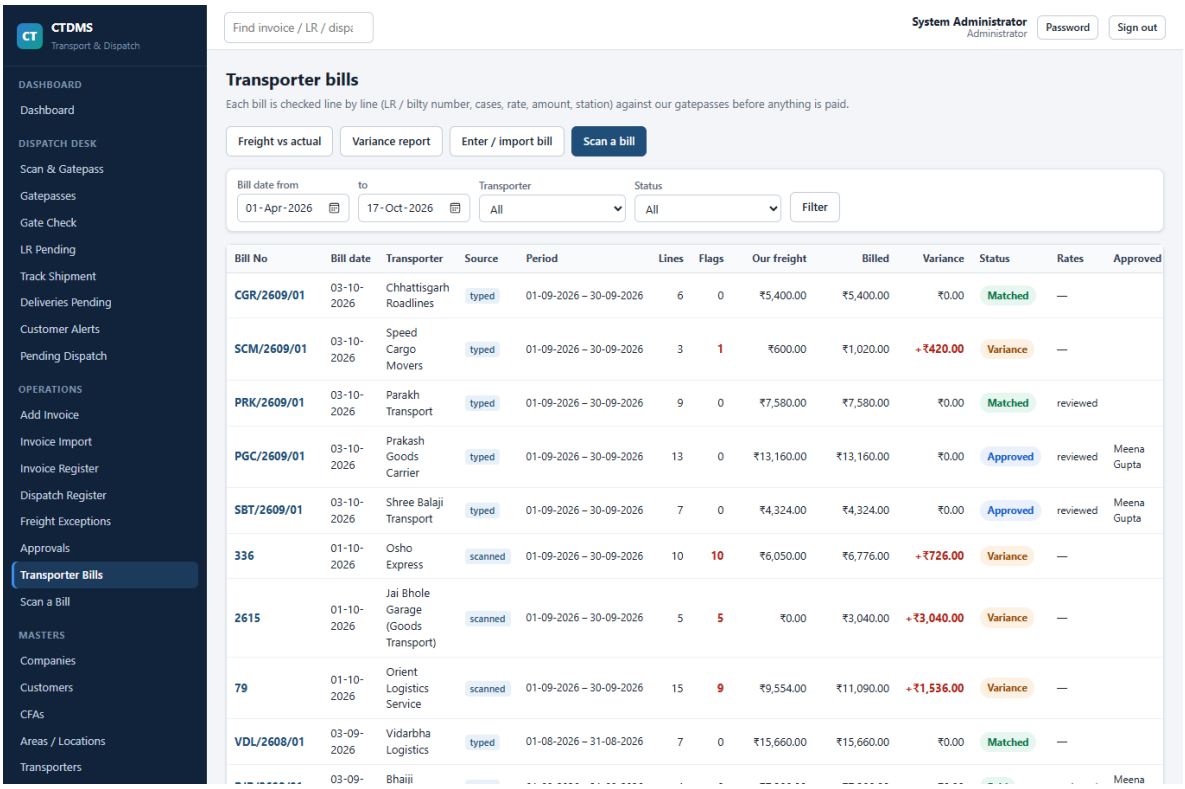
CAUTION Self-approval: the settings override.allow_self_approval, rate.allow_self_approval and recon.allow_self_approval decide whether a person may approve what they raised. For a real control, turn them **off** once you have at least two people.

Cancelling and voiding

- **Void a gatepass**: before gate-out only; reason required; invoices return to the queue.
- **Cancel an open dispatch**: Checker, CFA Manager or Master, reason required. **Reinstate** brings it back.
- **Cancel an already dispatched** invoice needs the special permission dispatch.cancel_dispatched, which only the Master has by default.

9. Transporter bills: checking what you are charged

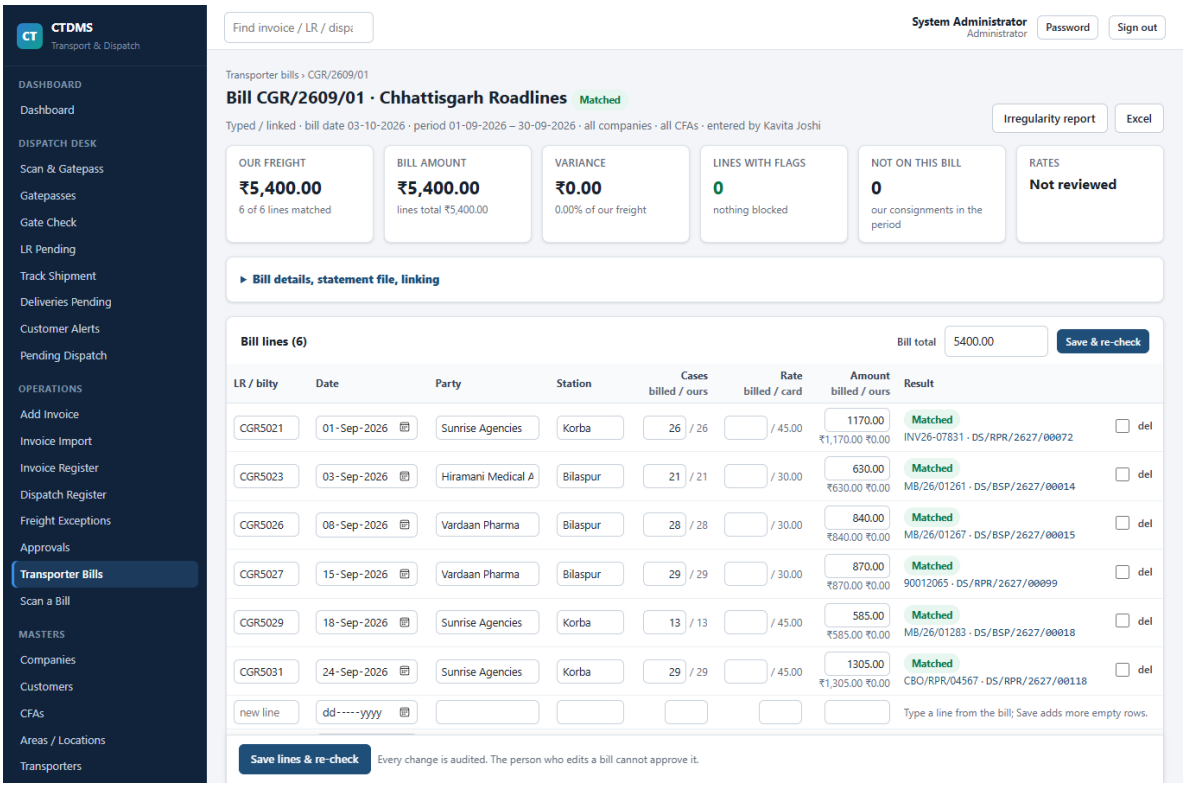
This protects the business from paying more than it should. Each line on a transporter's bill is matched against CTDMS's own gatepasses.



Transporter bills and their status.

Steps

1. **Scan a Bill**: choose the transporter, photograph each page (or upload the PDF), and type the lines next to the photo (LR / bilty no, date, party, station, cases, rate, amount). Automatic reading by AI is paid and is locked.
2. Alternatively import an Excel/CSV statement, or *Link period dispatches* to build a bill from your own gatepasses.
3. Press **Save lines & re-check**. Each line is cross-checked.
4. Open the **Irregularity report** (screen, print or Excel) for the conversation with the transporter.
5. Answer **Has the transporter changed any rates?** Tick areas to propose the new rate, or save with nothing ticked.
6. A **different person approves** (remarks needed for a variance), then **Mark paid** with the UTR.

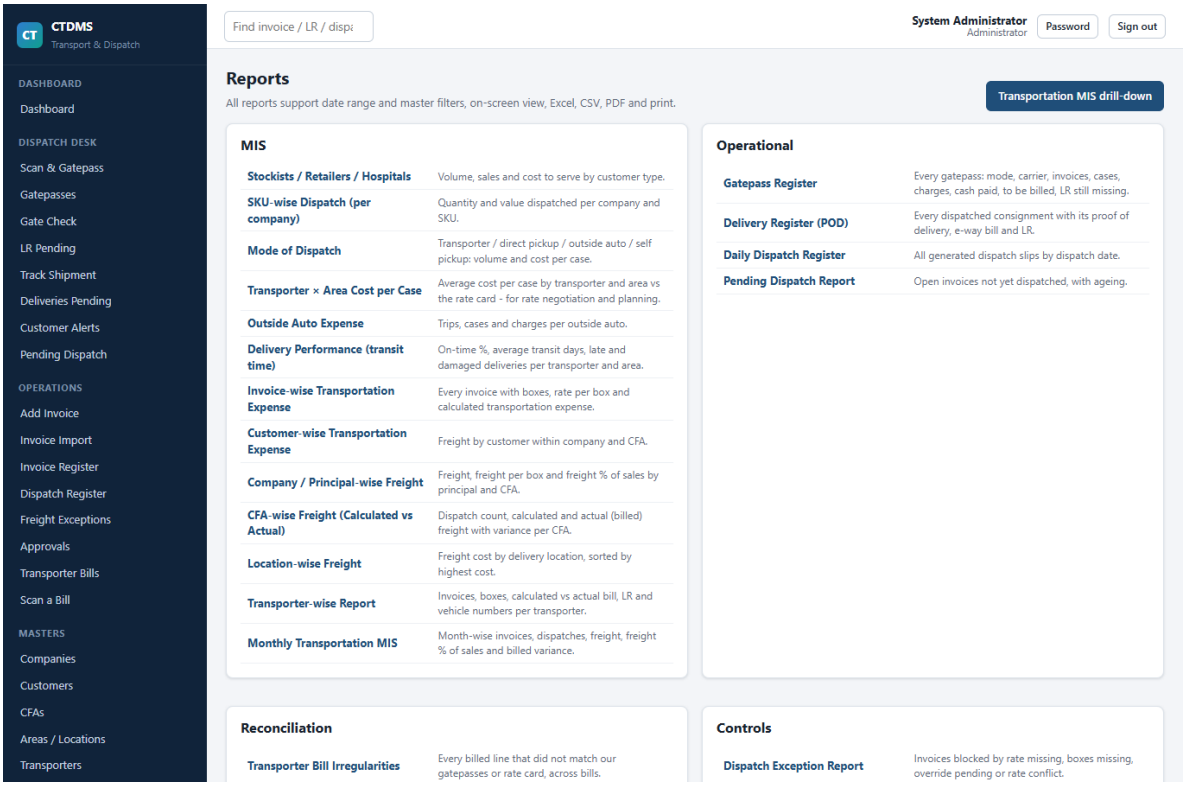


One bill: lines with check results, rate review, approve or reject.

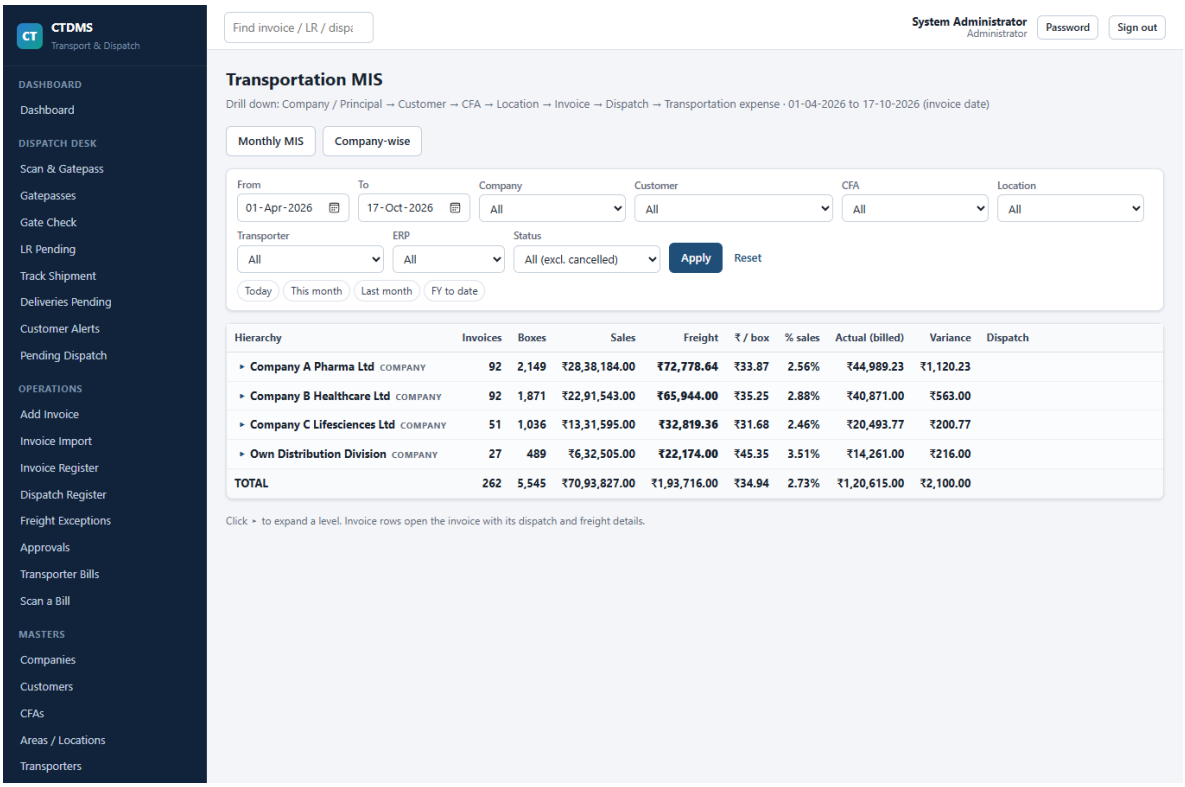
What the checks catch

Flag	Meaning	Can it be approved?
LR not in our dispatches	Billed LR does not exist with us. A 'Probably: …' suggestion appears when a consignment without LR matches; *This one* links it and writes the LR on our gatepass.	No, until linked or removed
Billed twice	Same LR on this bill or an earlier bill.	No
Already paid in cash	Paid at dispatch.	No
Not dispatched / other transporter's	Goods did not leave with this transporter.	No
More cases than dispatched	Billing more boxes than were sent.	With remarks
Rate differs from rate card	Beyond **recon.rate_tolerance**.	With remarks
Cases × rate ≠ amount; lines ≠ bill total; station / party / date mismatch	Arithmetic or detail errors.	With remarks
Our consignments in the period not on the bill	Possible under-billing or missing bill.	Information

10. Reports, MIS and exports



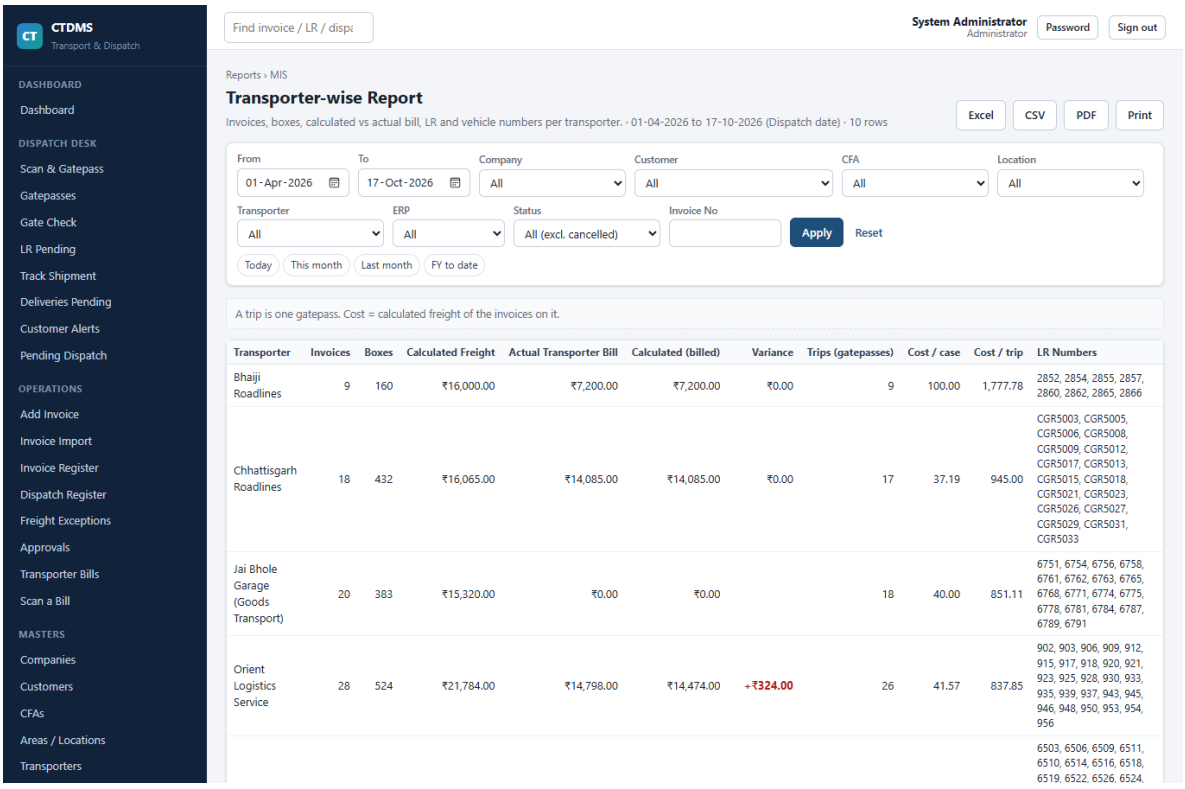
The full list of reports, in four groups: MIS, Operational, Reconciliation, Controls.



Transportation MIS with drill-down.

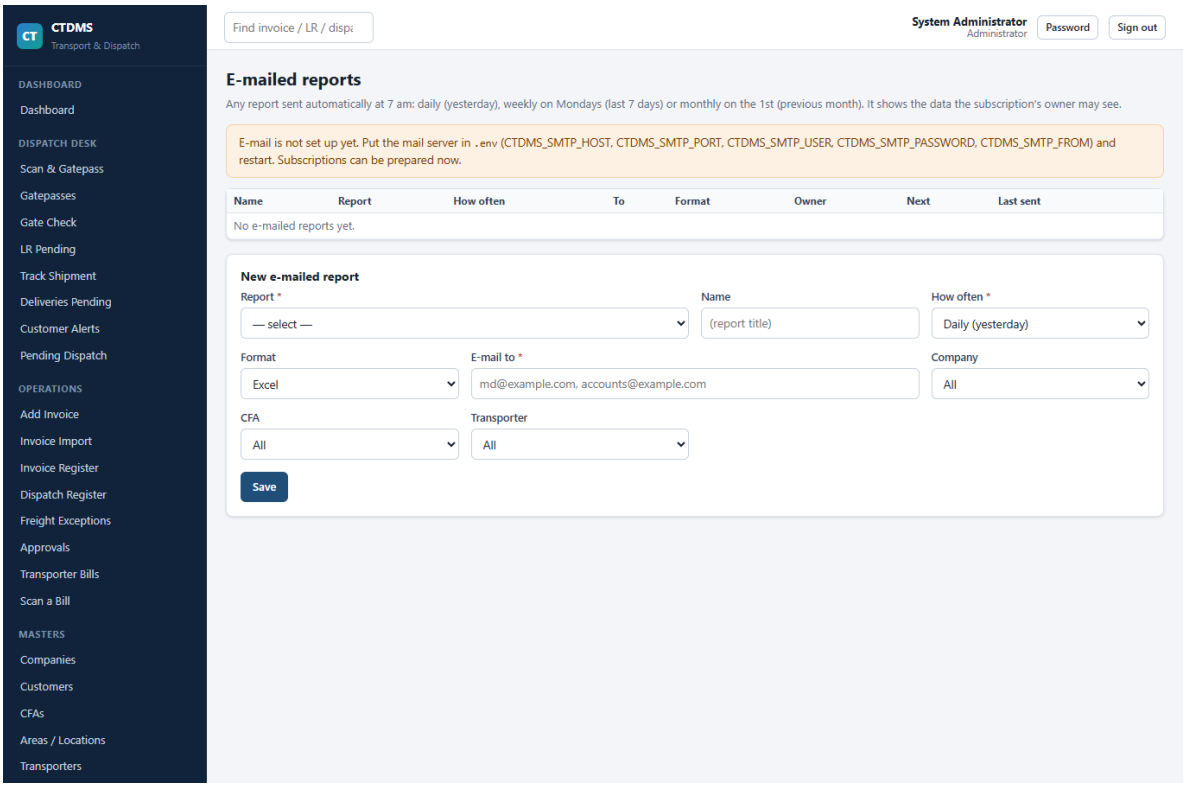
Every report has filters (dates, company, customer, CFA, location, transporter) and **Excel, CSV, PDF and Print** buttons, if the user holds the export permission. The Master can use all of them.

Report	Answers the question
Transportation MIS (drill-down, monthly)	Where does the freight money go, by company, CFA, location, transporter, month?
Company-wise / Customer-wise / CFA-wise / Location-wise	Who costs how much?
Transporter-wise	Trips, cost per case and cost per trip for each transporter.
Transporter × Area	Cost per case by transporter and area: who is cheapest where?
Gatepass Register	Every gatepass: who made it, carrier, cases, charge, gate-out.
SKU-wise Dispatch, Customer Types, Mode of Dispatch	What goes out, to whom, how.
Delivery Performance	On-time %, average transit days, late and damaged, by transporter and area.
Delivery Register (POD)	Proof-of-delivery list.
Variance	Calculated freight vs what was billed.
Bill Irregularities	All flagged lines from transporter bills.
Outside Auto Expense	Cash paid to autos.
Audit	Who changed what, when (see chapter 11).



Example: Transporter-wise report.

E-mailed reports

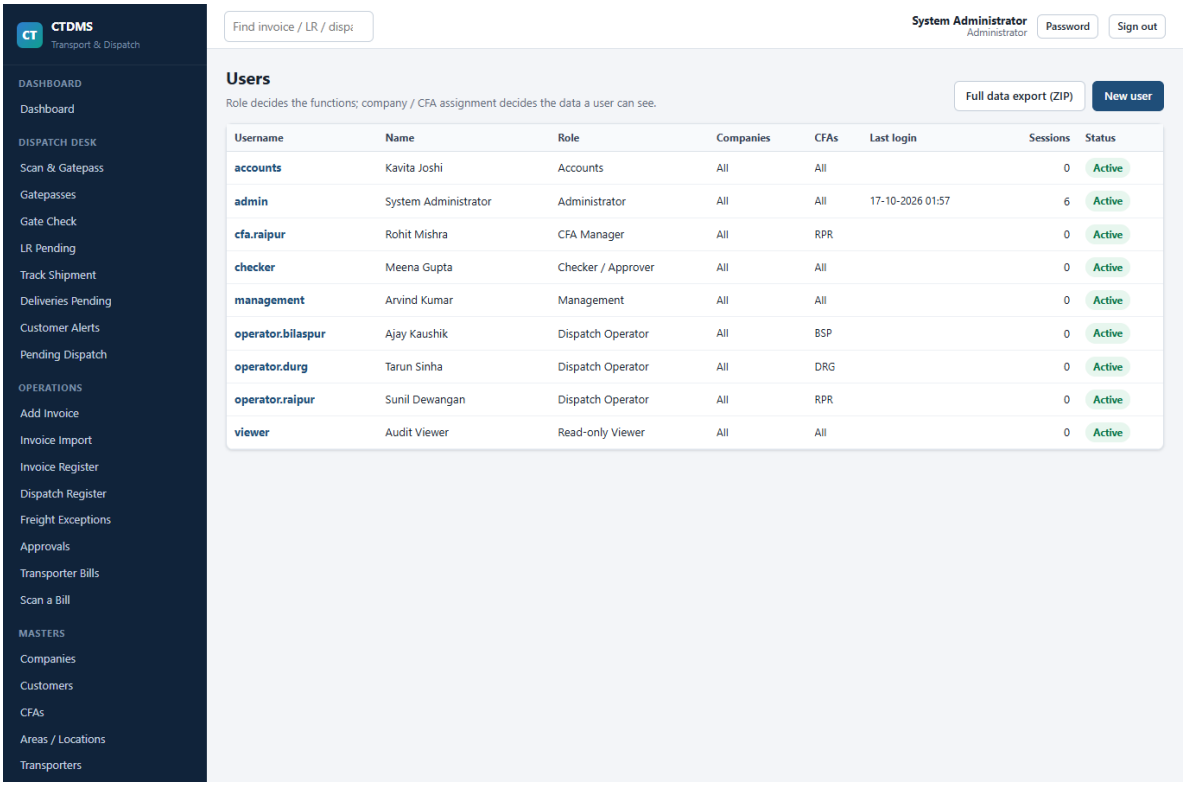


E-mailed Reports: schedule any report by e-mail.

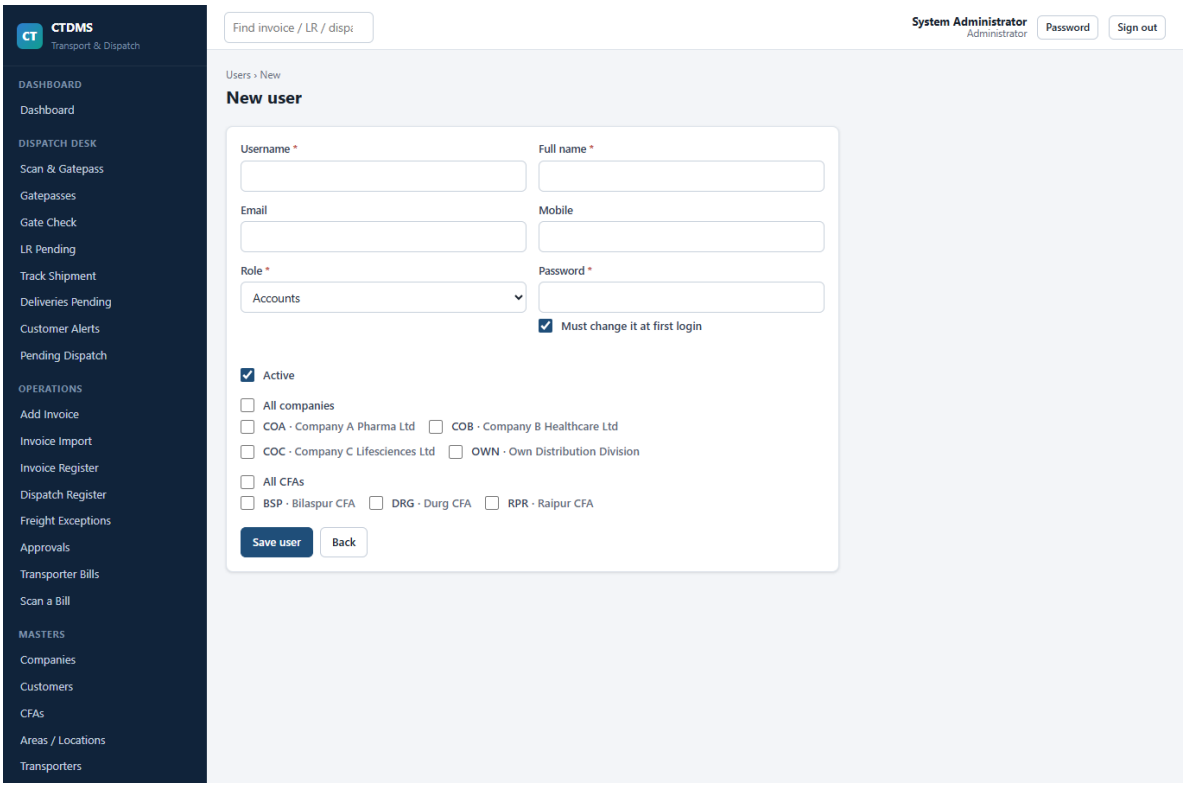
Choose a report, a frequency (daily at 7 am, weekly on Mondays, monthly on the 1st) and a format (Excel, CSV, PDF). Each report is sent with the data the owner may see, and never twice. This needs the office mail server to be entered in the **.env** file by your IT person.

11. Administration: Users, Roles, Settings, Audit

11.1 Users



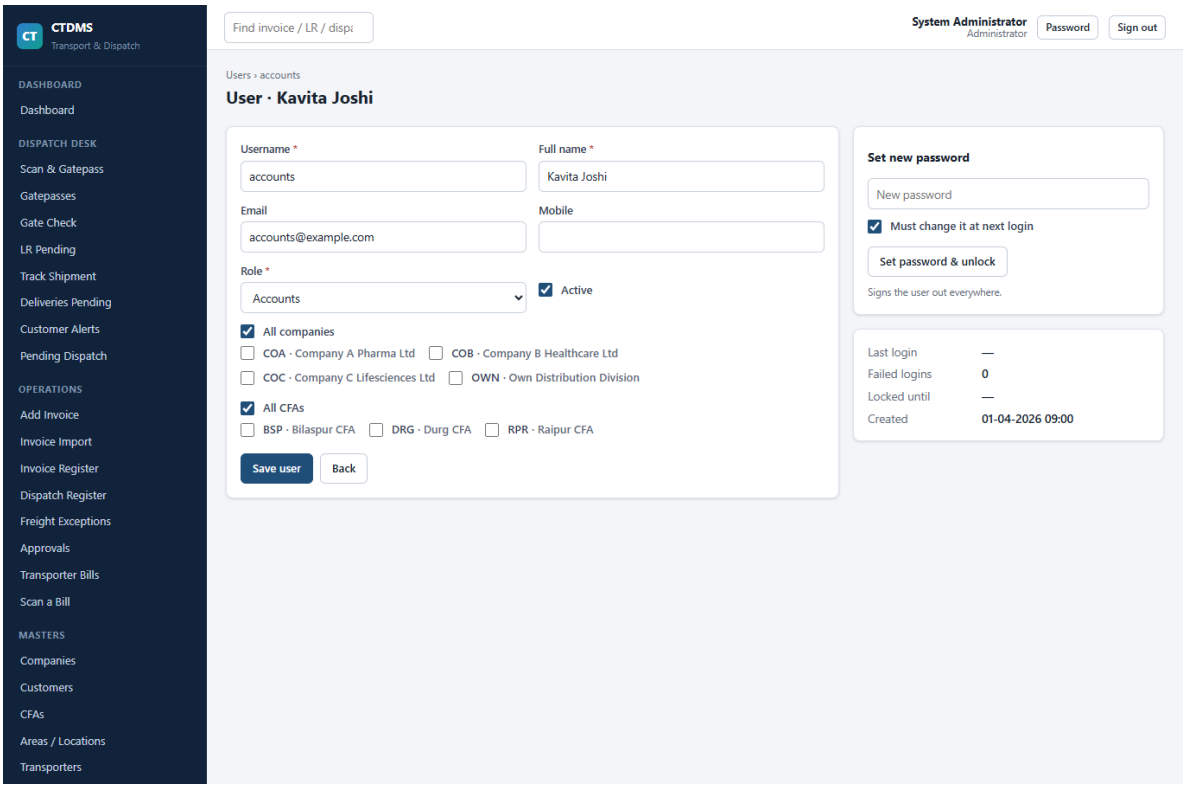
User list with role, scope and last login.



Creating a user.

1. Administration › Users › **New user**.
2. Enter username, full name, e-mail, mobile and choose the **role**.

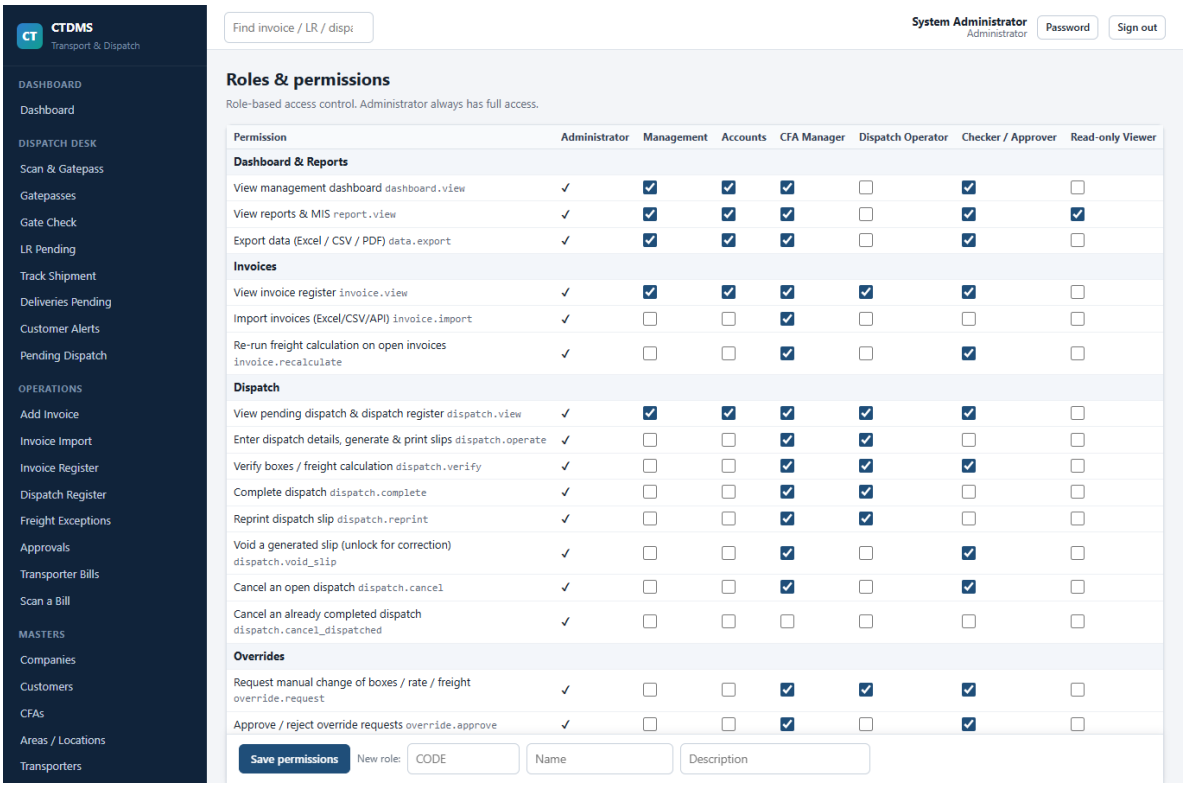
3. Choose the data scope: **All companies** / **All CFAs**, or tick only the ones this person may see. An Operator at Raipur should be limited to Raipur.
4. Type a password for them. Leave **Must change it at first login** ticked unless you are handing over a fixed password.
5. Save. Tell the person their username and password in person, not by group chat.



Editing a user: role, scope, active flag, set new password & unlock, last login.

- **Active** unticked = the person can no longer sign in. Use this when somebody leaves; do not delete.
- **Set password & unlock** sets a new password, clears a lockout and signs the person out everywhere.
- The side panel shows last login, failed logins and lock time.

11.2 Roles and permissions



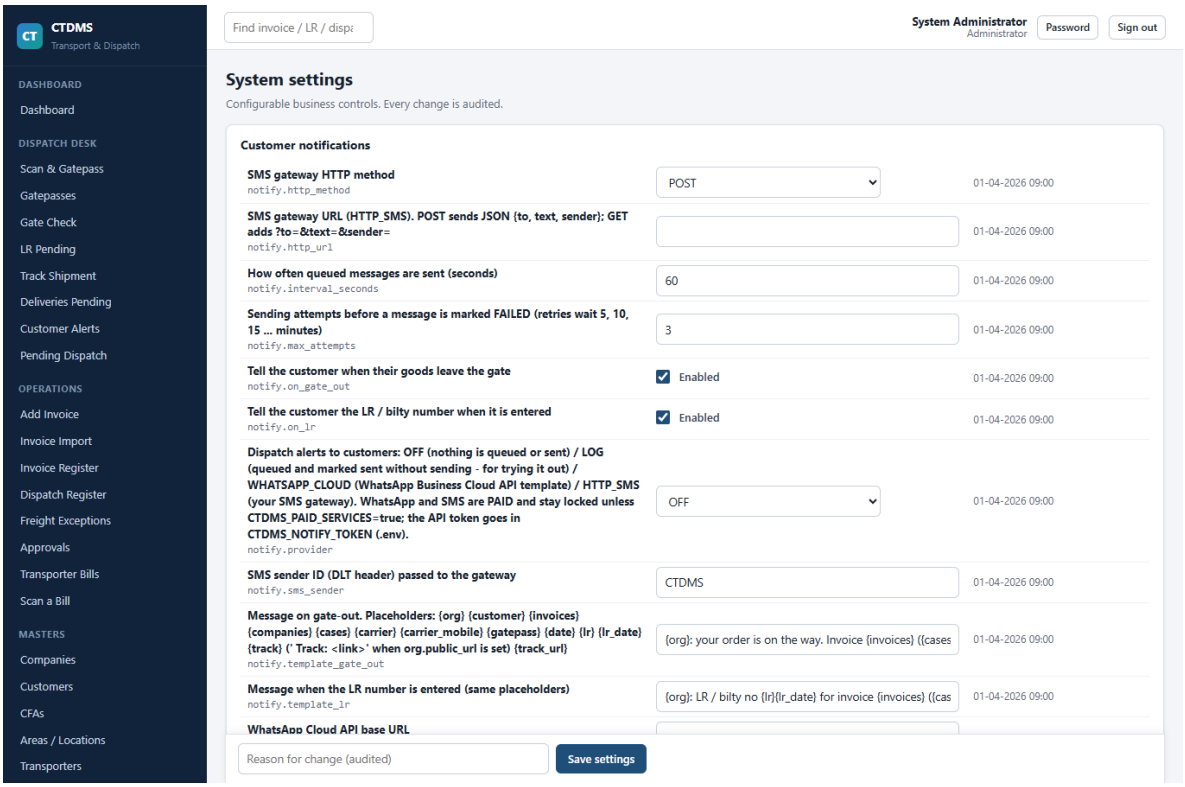
Roles & permissions grid: one column per role, one row per permission.

Each role is a set of tick-boxes. Change a box, press **Save permissions**. You can also add a **New role** (code, name, description). The Administrator role always has everything and cannot be reduced.

Role	Typical person	Can do (default)	Sees
Administrator	The Master	Everything	All
Management	Owner, directors	Dashboard, reports, invoices, dispatch, bills (view only), audit	All
Accounts	Accounts staff	Transporter bills: enter, approve, pay; reports and exports	All
CFA Manager	Manager of one CFA	Import, dispatch, gatepass, void, cancel, overrides, approve, rates, view bills	Own CFA(s)
Dispatch Operator	Warehouse desk	Pending dispatch, gatepass, print, request overrides	Own CFA(s)
Checker / Approver	Second pair of eyes	Verify, void, approve overrides, rates and bills, direct overrides, audit	All
Read-only Viewer	Visitor, auditor	Reports only (no export)	All

TIP Permission names are listed in the appendix. Before widening a role, ask: who would be able to approve their own work?

11.3 System settings



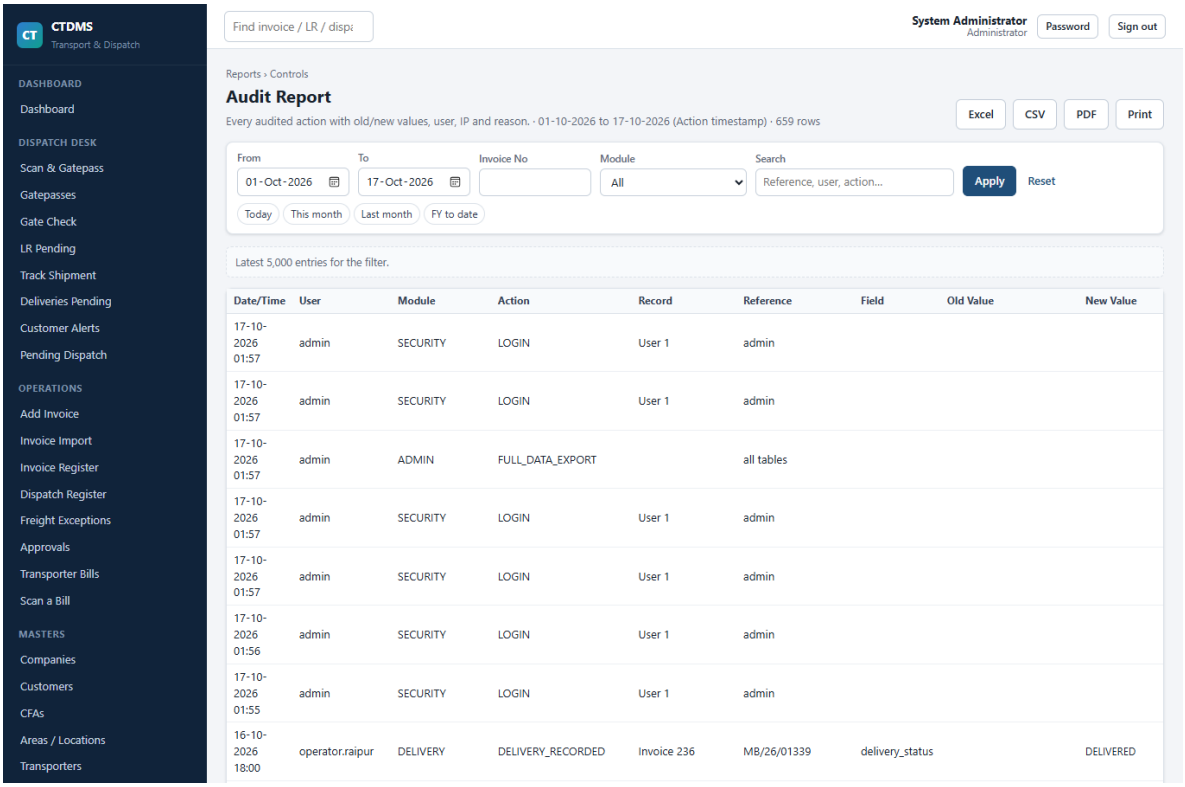
System settings, grouped by topic. Every change asks for a reason and is audited.

Type a reason at the bottom, press **Save settings**. The next screen reflects the change at once. The most important settings:

Setting (key)	What it controls	Advice
freight.source	Whether freight comes from the transporter rate card or the principal rate.	Keep TRANSPORTER.
rate.require_approval, rate.allow_self_approval	Whether new rates need a second person; whether the creator may approve.	Approval ON, self-approval OFF.
override.boxes_requires_approval, override.allow_self_approval	Approval for box-count changes.	ON / OFF.
recon.allow_self_approval	Whether the person who entered a bill may approve it.	OFF.
recon.tolerance_amount / tolerance_pct / rate_tolerance / match_window_days	How much difference is accepted before a bill line is flagged.	Start strict (small), loosen if too many false flags.
dispatch.complete_requires	Slip must be PRINTED / GENERATED / NONE before completing.	PRINTED.
dispatch.require_verify_before_slip, vehicle_mandatory, lr_mandatory	Fields and checks that must be done before a slip.	LR mandatory off (transporters give it later).
gate.eway_required_above	Gate-out blocked above this invoice value if no valid e-way bill. 0 = off.	50000 when you are ready.
gatepass.cash_paid_default	Autos and CASH transporters are marked paid at gatepass.	ON.
delivery.expected_days, link_days, customer_confirm	Days counted as on time; life of the customer link; may customers confirm?	Set expected days to your real norm.
inbox.enabled, interval_minutes	Automatic drop-folder import.	ON, 5 minutes.

Setting (key)	What it controls	Advice
import.allow_blank_boxes	Accept invoices without cases as exceptions.	ON.
einvoice.signature_check	OFF / WARN / BLOCK for QR signature check (needs the IRP public key).	WARN.
notify.provider	OFF / LOG / WhatsApp / SMS. WhatsApp and SMS are paid and locked.	OFF or LOG.
org.name, org.address, org.public_url	Name and address printed on documents; address for customer tracking links.	Fill in before printing.
slip.footer_note, dispatch.number_prefix, default_slip_size	Printed footer, numbering, paper.	

11.4 Audit log



Audit report: every business change, who made it and when.

Everything that changes business data is recorded: invoices, dispatches, gatepasses, rates, masters, users, settings, approvals, exports. Filter by date, user, type or record, and export to Excel, CSV or PDF. The Master should read this regularly (see the checklist). Nobody, including the Master, can edit or erase the log from the screen.

11.5 Data export and backup

Administration › Users has a **Full data export (ZIP)** button: one CSV file per table. Passwords and keys are not included. This is for review and for taking a copy to your own computer; it is **not** a replacement for the server's database backup (see chapter 13).

12. Problems that happen on the job, and what to do

A quick reference. Each line says what the user sees, why, and who fixes it.

What the user sees	Likely cause	Fix (and who)
Cannot sign in	Wrong password, or 5 wrong tries locked the account for 15 min.	Master: Users › user › Set password & unlock.
User says 'I don't see that menu / button'	Role has no permission, or scope excludes that CFA.	Master: Roles grid, or the user's company / CFA ticks.
'Access denied' / page not allowed	Same as above.	Master: change the role or the permission (chapter 11).
Invoice not found in Pending Dispatch	Out of that user's scope; not imported yet; cancelled; already dispatched.	Search the Invoice Register as Master and read its status and audit trail.
Import shows red rows	Unknown customer / area, blank cases, duplicates.	Fix the row in the batch, Retry (chapter 6).
Invoice stuck at RATE MISSING	No rate for this company / area / transporter.	Add rate, get it approved, recalculate (chapter 5).
Gatepass: area flagged no rate	Transporter's card has no rate for that area.	Add the rate under Transporter Rate Cards.
Cases differ from ERP	Count error or short supply.	Checker approves the change, or raise an override with a reason.
Wrong gatepass made	Wrong invoices or transporter.	Checker voids it before gate-out; make a new one.
Gate shows STOP	Void / unprinted / already used.	See table in 7.3.
Printer prints nothing / wrong size	Paper size setting or browser print dialog.	Choose A5 / A4 on the gatepass page; set dispatch.default_slip_size.
LR typed wrongly	Typing error.	Re-enter with a reason, until the bill is approved.
Goods short / damaged / refused	Delivery problem.	Record it on the consignment with a note and photo; it feeds Delivery Performance.
Transporter bill has unmatched LR	LR missing in our records.	Use 'Probably ...' link or reject the line (chapter 9).
Bill cannot be approved	Blocking flag (double billing, paid in cash, not dispatched).	Remove or correct the line; ask the transporter.
Approver cannot approve	It is their own request and self-approval is off.	Another person approves.
Report is empty	Date or filter too narrow; scope.	Press Reset, widen dates; check the user's scope.
E-mailed report did not arrive	Mail server not set in .env.	IT sets SMTP; use 'send' on the subscription to test.
Customer did not get a message	notify.provider is OFF or LOG; WhatsApp / SMS are locked.	Expected. See Customer Alerts.
Page is slow or does not open	Server computer off, busy or network down.	Check the office server and network; restart the app (chapter 13).

TIP When in doubt, search the invoice or gatepass number in the top-left box and read its **Audit trail**. It shows exactly what happened, who did it and when.

13. Looking after the system: Master's routine

Daily

- Dashboard: pending dispatch, rate-missing (should be 0), dispatch exceptions.
- Approvals: clear anything waiting.
- Deliveries Pending: overdue proofs of delivery.
- LR Pending: consignments without an LR number.
- Import log: any batch with problem rows.

Weekly

- Variance report and Transporter-wise cost per case.
- Transporter bills awaiting approval or payment.
- Audit report: overrides, voids, cancellations, setting changes, new users.
- Users: anyone who left should be inactive.

Monthly

- Monthly MIS and Delivery Performance for the management meeting.
- Review rate cards; propose rate changes with an effective date.
- Check backups really restore (ask IT to restore to a test copy).
- Review roles: does anyone have more permission than needed?

Starting and stopping the application (office server)

- On Windows, double-click **start_demo.bat** in the CTDMS folder. It prepares the database and opens the application. Existing data is never reset.
- Keep that window open while people work. Closing it stops the application.
- Daily database backups are in the **backups** folder (30 days kept on the Docker/production setup). Copy them off the server regularly.

Before real use (go-live checklist)

- Remove the demo users or give each a new password. Never keep 'Admin@123'.
- Turn off the clickable demo logins (CTDMS_SHOW_DEMO_LOGINS=false) and set a long CTDMS_SECRET_KEY in .env.
- Load real companies, CFAs, locations, customers, transporters and rate cards; test with a few real invoices.
- Set organisation name, address and the dispatch rules in System Settings.
- Create each real user with the right role and scope.
- Test a backup and a restore.
- Keep CTDMS_PAID_SERVICES=false unless the business decides to pay for AI bill reading or WhatsApp / SMS.

Paid features that are locked

Automatic reading of photographed bills (AI) and WhatsApp / SMS alerts need a paid outside service. They are **locked** by default. Everything else works without them: bills are typed next to the photo with every cross-check unchanged, and alerts can be previewed with the LOG provider.

Appendix A. Permission list

These are the tick-boxes on the Roles screen. The Administrator holds all of them.

Group	Permissions
Dashboard & Reports	View management dashboard; View reports & MIS; Export data (Excel / CSV / PDF)
Invoices	View invoice register; Import invoices; Re-run freight calculation on open invoices
Dispatch	View pending dispatch & register; Enter dispatch details, generate & print slips; Verify boxes / freight; Complete dispatch; Reprint slip; Void a generated slip; Cancel an open dispatch; Cancel an already completed dispatch
Overrides	Request manual change; Approve / reject; Apply directly (still audited)
Freight rates	View; Create / revise; Approve
Masters	View master data; Create / edit master data
Reconciliation	View transporter bills; Enter / import bills; Approve bills; Mark paid
Administration	View audit log; Manage users; Manage roles & permissions; Manage system settings; Manage ERP integrations; Download full data export

Appendix B. Words used in this manual

Term	Meaning
CFA	Carrying and forwarding agent: the warehouse that dispatches for the principal companies.
Principal / Company	The pharmaceutical company whose goods are dispatched.
Gatepass	One document and number for a whole pickup of goods.
LR / bilty	The transporter's consignment receipt number.
POD	Proof of delivery.
TBB	'To be billed': the transporter sends a bill later. CASH transporters are paid at dispatch.
RATE MISSING	Status of an invoice that has no freight rate yet.
Scope	The companies and CFAs a user is allowed to see.
Override	A manual change of cases, rate or freight, with a reason and an approval.
IRN / e-way bill	GST e-invoice reference and transport document numbers.